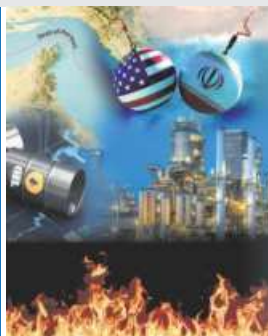


the hindu businessline

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Feeling the heat.
With war raging in W. Asia, oil stocks in India are under the spotlight
BIG STORY P2



Index Outlook.
Wrecking ball of conflict hits key indices as crucial supports break
CHART-GAZING P7

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

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How gold has stocks for breakfast

BULLION LESSON. In 10 years, only 26% of stocks have beaten gold; over one year, just 3% did as the shiny metal crushed equities

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl, research bureau

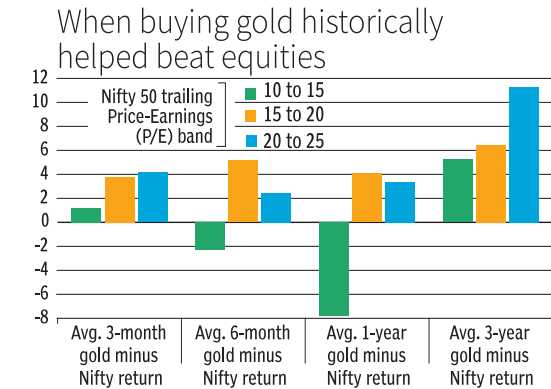
If Indian equities are supposed to reward patience, gold, often lampooned as a ‘dead’ asset, has spent the last decade mocking that promise. In the one year to March 13, 2026, gold (MCX spot prices) returned 82.86 per cent.

Out of roughly 1,134 NSE-listed stocks with sufficient trading history, only 37 or 3 per cent beat it. That means 97 per cent did not. But the real insult lies in the longer periods where equity investors usually demand respect for their endurance.

Over three years, gold returned 178.42 per cent and only 13 per cent of stocks beat it. Over five years, it returned 257.68 per cent and just 21 per cent beat it.

Over seven years, only 18 per cent got past gold’s 390.34 per cent return. Even over ten years, after all the sermons on compounding, discipline and staying invested, only 26 per cent of stocks managed to outperform gold’s 443.37 per cent gain.

So yes, Dalal Street may



Data source: Capitaline, Bloomberg. Gold return is based on MCX spot rates. Stock prices are adjusted for dividends. Stocks universe is 1134 NSE listed stocks that have trading history for all the above-mentioned periods. Nifty P/E band and gold returns analysis is based on regime-entry method i.e. counting only the point when the P/E first enters a band, not every instance it stays there.

have built an equity culture after Covid. But the precious metal has built a case file of crushing performance. This is what makes the old line about the Indian housewife being the world’s best fund manager so irritatingly durable.

HOUSEHOLD TRADE
While the formal investor learnt to say SIP, small-cap, tactical allocation and buy-on-dips, she kept buying gold. No earnings calls. No management guidance. No quarterly disappointment. Just a dull-looking metal

quietly doing the one thing equity markets never stop claiming to do for investors: preserve purchasing power and occasionally embarrass consensus.

And no, this is not merely one freak year of missiles, oil tanker worries and safe-haven panic. The yearly cuts show that gold has repeatedly been a difficult hurdle for stocks even when its own annual return was not spectacular. In the latest one-year period ended March 13, 2026, gold rose 82.86 per cent and only 3 per cent of stocks beat it. In the 2025 cut, gold re-

turned 32.57 per cent; still, 82 per cent of stocks failed to beat it. In 2023, gold returned only 8.59 per cent, yet 63 per cent of stocks still could not get past it.

In 2020, gold rose 29.9 per cent and a crushing 96 per cent of stocks lagged it. In 2019, gold’s return was just 6.57 per cent, and yet 84 per cent of stocks still failed to beat it. That is the larger embarrassment. Gold did not need to be brilliant every year. The stock universe merely needed to be ordinary, volatile or badly distributed. Equity bulls can, of

course, point to the friendlier windows. In the 2021 cut, when gold returned 5.54 per cent, 94 per cent of stocks beat it. In 2024, with gold up 14.85 per cent, 75 per cent did.

In 2017 and 2018 too, equities did better on breadth. But that actually strengthens the point. Equity culture remembers the party years and markets them as destiny. Gold waits for the more disorderly years and keeps winning enough of them.

VALUATIONS MATTER

The forward-looking clue in data is just as awkward for equity purists. When starting Nifty 50 valuations are not especially cheap, gold has often done well relative to the index.

When the Nifty 50 P/E (price to earnings) starts in the 20-25 band, gold beats the Nifty 50 by an average 11.27 percentage points over three years. In the 15-20 band, it beats by 6.44 points. Even in the 10-15 band, it still edges ahead over three years.

Gold’s own average three-year returns across starting valuation bands are hardly

meek either — 61.52 per cent from the 10-15 band, 46.31 per cent from 15-20 band, 48.05 per cent from 20-25 band.

The joke, then, is on modern portfolio snobbery. The asset long treated as backward, unproductive and a little too attached to family lockers has spent years exposing just how few stocks actually deliver the heroic long-term story investors are sold.

Gold may not produce cash flows. But it has produced something just as valuable over the past decade — discomfort for anyone who thought equities would easily leave it behind.

None of this means investors should dump equities and marry bullion. It simply means gold has historically looked most useful when fear is rising, liquidity is uncertain, and equities are not entering from obviously cheap valuations.

In plain English, when the market is expensive, the world is noisy and everyone is pretending this is normal, gold deserves more respect than the average stock bull likes to give it.

Goyal promises exporters more support; acknowledges war may slow economy briefly

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal urged businesses and consumers not to panic amid disruptions caused by the Gulf conflict, and said the government was engaging with exporters daily to mitigate losses and promised more actions to support them.

Speaking at a business leaders awards event, Goyal said his Ministry has worked out certain schemes to help create an insurance cover should any export cargo be damaged, lost or delayed because of the Red Sea or the Strait of Hormuz problem or shipping line difficulties.

“We...are doing inter-ministerial consultations. Next week

we will come out with a more concrete agenda to support exporters,” he added. The government was engaging with export promotion councils, setting up 24-hour helplines and establishing SOPs “to... ensure exporters don’t face any problem, or importers for that matter.”

He acknowledged the war had created challenges for trade, energy supplies and financial markets, and there could be short-term slowdown.

About the weakening rupee, Goyal said the pressure largely reflected global investor risk aversion during conflicts. He pointed to strong foreign exchange reserves held by the RBI, equivalent to nearly a year of imports, as a key buffer.

Akasa Air to levy fuel charge of ₹199 to ₹1,300 on local, global routes

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Akasa Air will introduce a fuel surcharge ranging from ₹199 to ₹1,300 on domestic and international routes in view of the spike in fuel prices triggered by the West Asia crisis, the airline said on Saturday.

The surcharge will be applicable on all bookings from Saturday midnight and will vary based on flight duration.

“There has been a significant increase in the price of aviation turbine fuel, driven by evolving geopolitical developments in the Middle East. As fuel represents a significant portion of the airline operating costs, this impacts the cost of operations across the aviation industry,” Akasa Air said.

India engages with Iran, GCC, US as LPG, LNG carriers await Hormuz Strait passage

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The government has stepped up dialogues with Iran as tankers carrying liquefied natural gas (LNG) and LPG — likely a month’s supply for the country — await safe passage through the Strait of Hormuz (SoH).

The development follows a flurry of talks — led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Foreign Minister S Jaishankar — that helped clear the passage for two tankers carrying 92,712 tonnes of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) through the 34-km Strait. Rakesh Kumar Sinha,



STUCK AT SEA. An LPG gas tanker lies at anchor in Shinas, Oman, with traffic disrupted in the Strait of Hormuz REUTERS

Special Secretary, Shipping Ministry, said on Saturday that six tankers carrying LPG and a tanker loaded with LNG are in the west of SoH awaiting safe transit.

2 VESSELS CLEAR SOH
Two Indian-flagged LPG carriers, Shivalik and Nanda Devi, crossed the SoH early on Saturday and are expected to dock at

Mundra and Kandla ports on March 16 and March 17, respectively. Both are carrying roughly 46,000 tonnes each LPG.

It is likely that the other six LPG carriers are carrying the same volume, bringing the cumulative tonnage to around 2.76 lakh tonnes. India’s average monthly LPG consumption stood at 2.81 mt during 11M FY26.

Commenting on India’s efforts, Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said: “India has remained in close contact with key stakeholders including GCC countries, Iran, the US and Israel at political and diplomatic levels. The Prime Minister,

the External Affairs Minister and Indian Missions have been actively engaging with counterparts to underline India’s priorities, particularly energy security and safe maritime transit.”

VESSELS ON HOLD
Apart from Shivalik and Nanda Devi, several other Indian-bound vessels remain on standby in the Gulf region and efforts are ongoing to ensure safe and uninterrupted passage, he added.

Four tankers carrying crude oil, three container ships and two bulk carriers also await safe passage through the world’s most critical energy choke point, Sinha said.

Iran war blows up food prices in Gulf as logistics disarray leads to shortages, soaring freight rates

V Sajeed Kumar
Subramani Ra Mancombu
Kochi/Chennai



The Iran war is leading to food inflation in the Gulf region, primarily the United Arab Emirates, with sea and air routes affected since February 27.

Multiple sources told *businessline* that prices of vegetables and fruits have doubled, while stocks of foodgrains, mainly rice, are thinning.

“Last week, vegetable trays in some shops in Sharjah were empty. This week, prices have come down a tad,” said a Sharjah-based person from Kerala.

“Prices are sky high. Tomato and onion that were 1 AED (United Arab Emirates dirham) are ruling at 6 and 5 AED now. The availability of groceries at *kirana* shops is okay as of

now,” said a Dubai-based person from Tamil Nadu.

MANAGING SUPPLIES
A trading source said the UAE has only a fortnight’s stock of premium rice varieties, while ordinary varieties may last 45 days. The Gulf country could soon run out of potatoes.

Dubai-based fruits importer CEV Muhammed Siraj told *businessline* over the phone that the Gulf markets have begun to experience shortages of sev-

Pricey veggies, fruits*

Commodity	February	March
Onions	2.0-4.0	5.0-8.0
Tomatoes	2.75-5.0	5.5-10.0
Potatoes	1.50-3.50	3.0-4.50
Carrots	3.50-5.0	5.0-6.50
Cucumber	3.0-4.0	5.0-7.5
Oranges	4.50-6.50	8.0-11.0
Bananas	4.50-5.50	7.0-9.50
Apples	6.0-8.50	9.0-11.0

eral products from India in the wake of the crisis.

“Traders are currently managing supplies through shipments from Sri Lanka, Vietnam and Thailand. However, rising freight costs have forced many buyers to defer purchases,” Siraj said.

This being the Ramadan season, demand for pineapple and other fruits are high, but consumers are having to cope up with limited availability, he said.

FREIGHT RATE TRIPLES
Munshid Ali, General Secretary of the Kerala Exporters Forum, said his firm had received shipment orders for 2,000 kg of pineapple and 27 tonnes of coconut from Tamil Nadu to meet the festival demand.

However, soaring freight charges have made shipment unviable. The air freight cost for pineapple from Kerala airports soared from ₹70-80 a kg to around ₹210, prompting buyers to cancel orders. “For coconuts, container freight has climbed to around \$3,800,” he said.

Asked how traders are navigating shipping routes amid the conflict, Ali said some cargo is being routed through Khor Fakkan Port on Sharjah’s east coast, which operates outside the Strait of Hormuz.

The Chennaite said rulers in the Emirates have

assured food security and are looking to import via air.

“Saudi Arabia and Oman have other routes to cater to the Gulf Cooperative Council through road because Red Sea and Oman ports do not need to use the Strait of Hormuz,” Munshid Ali said.

DISRUPTED LOGISTICS
The UAE is taking Oman’s help due to its proximity and things are being managed through road.

Ali said over 150 tonnes of perishable exports from Kerala are stranded. Both air and sea cargo routes have been severely affected, disrupting exports.

Although some urgent supplies are being flown in by companies such as the Lulu Group, the broader logistics chain remains severely disrupted, impacting consumers in West Asia, he said.

Markets must function smoothly even in times of volatility: SEBI chief

Our Bureau
Mumbai



Tuhin Kanta Pandey, Chairman, SEBI

Financial markets must be designed to function efficiently even during periods of uncertainty, as volatility is an inherent feature of capital markets, Securities and Exchange Board of India Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey has said.

“If we look at the global economic landscape today, one word appears repeatedly: uncertainty,” Pandey said at the Money-control Global Wealth Summit 2026 here on Saturday. The conflict in the Middle East has disrupted energy supplies and created volatility in global oil and gas markets, he said.

Markets have faced similar shocks in the past but have eventually stabilised. Pandey noted that disruptions during the Covid-19 pandemic and the Russia-Ukraine war had triggered

global market volatility, but markets ultimately regained stability.

“For many investors — especially retail — the best strategy during such periods of uncertainty is to remain patient,” he said. “News travels quickly. Opinions travel even faster. And, most importantly, markets today react almost instantly to narratives,” Pandey said.

SPEED VS STABILITY

The key challenge for policymakers and market participants is ensuring that the

speed of modern markets does not compromise stability.

“In uncertain times, the strength of a capital market does not lie in the absence of volatility. Volatility is a natural feature of markets. The real strength lies in the confidence that the system will function fairly, transparently and efficiently even during periods of stress,” he said.

SEBI has undertaken several initiatives in recent years to improve market efficiency and facilitate capital formation. These include reducing the settlement cycle to lower settlement risk, and expanding the Electronic Book Provider (EBP) mechanism to include REITs and InvITs.

The regulator has also simplified participation for global investors and taken steps to improve operational efficiency across the market ecosystem. Expanding investor participation is another priority, Pandey said.

bl.portfolio

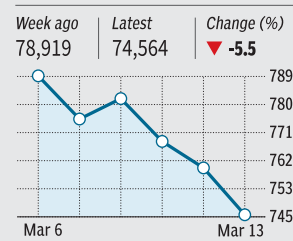
WISE WORDS.

“A market crash is nothing but risk-aversion meeting a market that’s not priced to tolerate risk.”

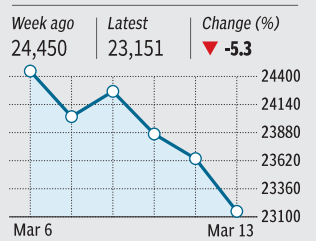
JOHN P. HUSSMAN,
President, Hussman Investment Trust

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY



Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl, research bureau

Is there enough LPG for India’s needs, is the burning question on everyone’s mind right now. The ongoing hostilities between US-Israel and Iran have squarely turned the spotlight on India’s oil infrastructure and the companies that own and operate it.

India imports over 90 per cent of the crude it consumes and crude-based petroleum products form about 30 per cent of its energy mix. Coal leads—accounting for over 50 per cent. Given this situation, oil infrastructure that includes oil fields, pipelines, refineries and marketing network (fuel stations) assumes national importance and critical for India’s energy security. Hence, PSUs play a significant role across the infrastructure and the value chain in this space.

Upstream, companies such as ONGC and Oil India (OIL) handle exploration and production activities. Downstream, the three oil marketing companies (OMCs)—IOCL, BPCL and HPCL—along with two pure-play refiners, MRPL and CPCL, manage refining operations. The OMCs also operate pipelines that transport crude oil and petroleum products. Together with dedicated pipeline operators like GAIL, they form the core of the midstream segment, which focuses on the storage and transportation of oil and gas.

Since a handful of PSUs cater to the entire subcontinent, the scale associated with them is anything but modest—170 mt per annum (million tonnes) of refining capacity, accounting for two-thirds of the nation’s capacity, 35,000 km in pipelines (Srinagar and Kanyakumari are 3,000 km apart for context), 92,000 retail fuel outlets and ₹19 lakh crore (\$210 billion) in revenue.

However, their market values are low at about ₹8 lakh crore or \$85 billion (HPCL and MRPL are subsidiaries of ONGC, and CPCL is a subsidiary of IOCL; hence, market caps of only parent companies are considered here and for revenue above) and trade at paltry mid-single-digit or high single-digit PEs. This was even before the US-Iran war started, and some of them have been under pressure since. Yet, their low valuation is an attraction for many investors, especially retail investors. With crude climbing 42 per cent since the war broke out, shares of some of them, especially those of the OMCs, have crashed anywhere between 15 per cent and 20 per cent—making them further cheaper. This has placed them back squarely in the spotlight again.

Are they value stocks or is their low PEs only optics? It can be both at different points in time!

We attempt to decode this puzzle by looking at history, which has always served as a reliable guide to approach markets.

Given that today’s scenario closely resembles the situation when the Russia-Ukraine war broke out in 2022, we draw parallels and take stock of what’s ahead for the stocks.

BRASS TACKS

Before diving in, it helps to understand why these companies do not fetch healthy valuations. The primary reason is that they have little control over market prices.

Upstream companies make money when crude price rises and vice-versa, but cannot influence the market price of crude. Even in a scenario where crude price sustains at higher levels, the government could step in and slap a windfall tax, limiting their earnings potential.

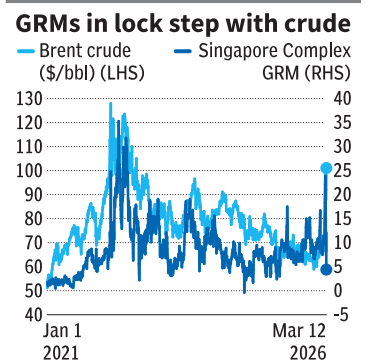
On the other hand, prospects of refineries depend on something called gross refining margin (GRM), which essentially is the gross profit per barrel of crude processed, calculated as total revenue from refined products



Stocks in the line of fire

DEJA VU. With war raging in West Asia, oil PSUs in India are under the spotlight. Are they value bets or value traps? Given the similarity, we draw parallels with the Russia-Ukraine war to decode the puzzle

minus the cost of raw materials. Revenue depends on global benchmark prices of the petroleum products, and cost—where crude is a substantial part—also depends on global price trends—something refineries barely have any influence on. Hence, their earnings largely track global GRM benchmarks, such as the Singapore GRM, which is the benchmark for Asia. Global GRM benchmarks, in turn, are largely driven by the global demand for petroleum products, the demand for refining capacity and the price of crude. Generally, GRMs tend to track crude prices—higher crude prices would mean higher GRMs and vice-versa.



That said, there are certain factors that are still within refineries’ control such as scale of operations, operational efficiency, viscosity and sourness of crude, among others. A refinery can very well work with these variables, manage higher yields and eke out higher margin or premium over and above global GRM benchmarks. These make refineries relatively better insulated from volatility compared with upstream players and OMCs.

Further, if it is windfall tax for upstream companies, it is export duty for refineries. The government could impose a duty on export of diesel, for instance, if, in its judgment, exports are to be routed into the domestic market to rein in inflation, as it happened in FY23.

The above aspects apply to both standalone refineries and refineries operated by OMCs alike.

Let’s move on to OMCs. Once crude is refined, they move the output to the market. Again, the market price/retail price of petroleum products while officially deregulated, the government still exerts control

How stocks performed

	% change in share price				
	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25	FYTD26
IOC	30	-2	115	-24	23
BPCL	-16	-4	75	-8	15
HPCL	15	-12	101	14	2
MRPL	7	26	316	-38	33
CPCL	27	86	282	-32	49
ONGC	60	-8	77	-8	7
OIL	94	6	139	-3	22

Returns measured between financial year ends
FYTD: Financial year-to-date

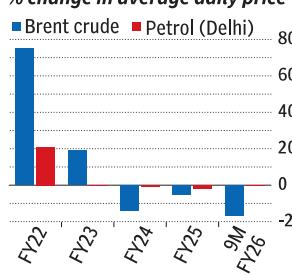
Profits as volatile as crude

	% change in adjusted EPS				
	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
IOCL	2128	11	-57	295	-67
BPCL	343	-30	-75	782	-51
HPCL	238	-28	-196	333	-58
MRPL	77	490	-10	39	-98
CPCL	113	428	162	-22	-92
ONGC	296	167	-9	27	-21
OIL	-20	33	59	-30	4

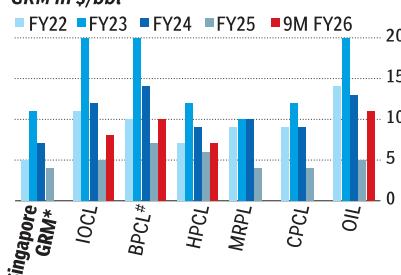
Values less than -100 represent company slipping into losses

How players fared financially

% change in average daily price



GRM in \$/bbl



	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25	9M FY26
% change in operating profit**					
IOCL	14	-18	94	-49	151
BPCL	-6	-32	224	-42	77
HPCL	-37	-171	446	-32	99
MRPL	602	32	20	-71	336
CPCL	35	110	-21	-77	1,078
ONGC	53	4	27	-9	16
OIL	120	22	-20	-10	-14

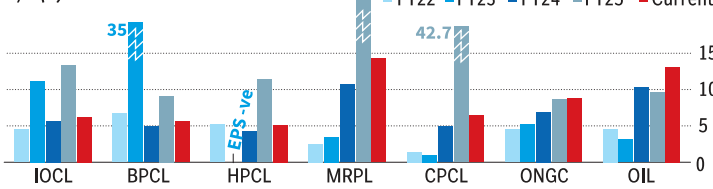
*As reported by IOC #For lack of 9M FY26 GRM, average of GRMs in Q1-Q3 of FY26 used here
**Operating profit - adjusted EBITDA
ONGC’s refinery operations are with subsidiaries HPCL and MRPL and so excluded from GRM chart

Valuation range (in the last five years)

	P/E (x)			P/B (x)		
	At stock's bottom	At stock's peak	Current	At stock's bottom	At stock's peak	Current
IOC^	4.6	5.8	6.2	0.7	1.6	1.1
BPCL	EPS -ve	6.8	5.6	1.4	1.7	1.4
HPCL	EPS -ve	6.9	5.1	1.0	1.8	1.3
MRPL	EPS -ve	11.5	14.3	1.5	4.1	2.1
CPCL	5.4	7.1	6.4	0.9	2.0	1.4
ONGC	7.6	9.7	8.7	0.6	1.1	0.8
OIL	3.5	17.7	13.1	0.5	2.6	1.5
Nifty 50			19.2			3.1

*Though IOC’s lowest point fell in April 2021, its bottom after the Ukraine war has been considered for comparison with OMC peers

P/E (x) as at FY ends



Source: Bloomberg, Capitaline, Exchange filings, bl.portfolio calculations

over retail prices of petrol, diesel and LPG. In a rising crude scenario, their refineries could profit from higher GRMs but would suffer marketing losses if government does not allow them to proportionately raise prices of petroleum products. This phenomenon is known as under-recovery.

When all such variables do their thing, it translates into wild volatility in earnings for the players involved (see chart). All in all, volatile prices, inability to influence pricing and regulations mean the stocks trade at lower multiples.

MIRRORING 2022-23

Given the war in the Gulf and spiking crude prices, today’s scenario can have parallels to what companies

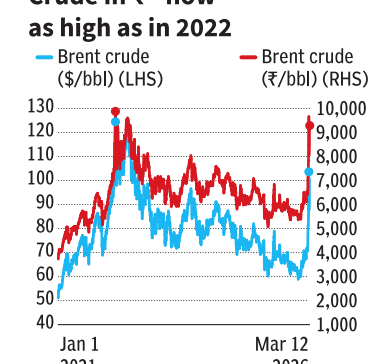
went through in FY23—the fiscal year after the breakout of the Russia-Ukraine war in February 2022. Russian crude, which accounts for roughly 10 per cent of the global crude production, was sanctioned by the West. Crude price shot up 17 per cent in just a week (five trading days) of war—from \$97 a barrel to \$113. In the days that followed, crude hit a peak of \$138. From this peak, though oil cooled, it sustained at higher prices—between \$100 and \$120 a barrel for three-four months.

Today’s situation, though similar, is far worse. A week into the war, crude has gained 28 per cent—from \$73 to \$93 and till date crude has gained 42 per cent. It peaked last week at \$120 a barrel briefly, but has traded in a volatile range of \$80-100 in

the days after. Last time, only about 10 per cent of global crude trade was initially interrupted and went out of supply until Russian crude found its way into countries such as China and India. This time, over 20 per cent of global supply is at stake, as roughly the same amount passes through the Strait of Hormuz.

Another reason why this time could be a lot worse is that with rupee depreciating 20 per cent since the Ukraine War, the rupee cost of crude is as close as it was during that war. Back then, though crude was trading at \$120-130, a dollar costed just ₹77. Now though crude prices are relatively lower than those levels, a dollar costs a lot today at ₹92.

Crude in ₹ - now as high as in 2022



ENERGY ECONOMICS

We will now make sense of how companies fare and shares react, beginning with FY22 to 9M FY26. Though the aftermath of the Ukraine war was seen in FY23, it would help to build a base with FY22. We have analysed financials with EBITDA as it is common for oil firms to post healthy net profit in a year and massive losses in the next, for the same quantum of revenue. Readers can refer to relevant charts as they read the following.

Year before the war: In FY22, crude price shot up 75 per cent over FY21 on an average daily price basis (\$46 in FY21 to \$80 in FY22). On a point-to-point basis (April 2021 to March 2022) it ranged between \$65 and \$110. GRMs (both benchmark and of refiners) rose in tandem, boosted by inventory gains. Inventory gains accrue because the benchmark price of finished products and hence the crack spreads (price difference between refined products and crude) would have aligned to rising crude price, but the products themselves would have been processed from older/cheaper crude stock, purchased before the oil rally. Conversely, firms incur inventory losses when crude price falls—thus bringing GRMs down. For the OMCs, while higher GRMs would mean healthy profits in their refining business, the catch here is that their marketing under-recoveries offset this gain. For standalone refiners though, their fortunes are directly linked to GRM trends.

Price charged to dealers too were hiked from ₹33/litre (petrol in Delhi) in March 2021 to ₹54/litre in March 2022. Despite higher fuel prices and GRMs, OMCs incurred marketing losses. HPCL’s EBITDA declined the most (see chart), as its GRM is inferior to that of IOCL and BPCL. IOCL managed a 14-per cent EBITDA growth, aided by superior GRM and a balanced marketing-to-refining ratio

(quantity of fuel marketed divided by quantity of crude processed) at 1.1x—an advantage BPCL (1.3x) and HPCL (2.8x) didn’t have. During periods of under-recoveries, companies with a higher ratio will underperform. Standalone refineries capitalised on higher GRMs, while upstream players gained from higher crude and natural gas prices.

The aftermath: Come FY23, crude sustained between \$100 and \$120 for about four months till July-end. This prompted the government to impose a windfall tax on crude produced by upstream players and a duty on export of petrol, diesel and ATF by the refiners and OMCs (duty on petrol was suspended shortly). From July, oil went on a decline towards \$80 by the fiscal-end. GRMs, too, peaked in FY23. However, with petrol, diesel prices remaining constant, refining margins could not offset marketing losses. What added to the pain was the massive LPG under-recoveries—of about ₹30,000 crore (as per Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell), driven by elevated import prices (India imports roughly 60 per cent of the LPG it consumes). HPCL slipped into losses in FY23, while IOCL and BPCL saw their EBITDA decline. MRPL and CPCL continued to capitalise on higher GRMs, with MRPL’s EBITDA growth normalising on a high base. OIL was the least impacted, as its business is limited just to upstream and refining (Numaligarh) operations. HPCL’s losses ate into ONGC’s upstream gains, leading to a modest 4 per cent EBITDA growth.

Stocks of the three OMCs plummeted in FY23, finding support only by September-October. IOCL, BPCL and HPCL declined 16 per cent, 17 per cent and 30 per cent respectively from their prices before the start of the war. Shares of upstream players and standalone refiners gained on the other hand. Since the start of the war to their FY23 peak, MRPL, CPCL, OIL and ONGC rose 189 per cent, 271 per cent, 36 per cent and 16 per cent.

OMCs recover: FY24 was a year of recovery for the OMCs. Crude corrected 14 per cent more versus FY23 (on average basis as above) and retail prices remained unchanged. GRMs normalised, with inventory gains reversing. OIL saw EBITDA degrowth owing to its upstream operations. ONGC’s upstream operations posted modest EBITDA growth, while HPCL’s EBITDA recovered to offer growth at the consolidated level. CPCL’s EBITDA degrew as GRM fell. Export duties on diesel and ATF were done away with in this fiscal.

Shares of OMCs rallied to their FY24 peaks from FY23 lows. Shares of MRPL and CPCL saw large corrections as they factored in reversal of FY23 inventory gains and subsequent decline in GRMs (see FY25 GRM). HPCL’s recovery meant ONGC shares rallied too. Oil India too rallied on the back of a revised pricing policy for natural gas, which is an advantage for ONGC’s gas business as well.

Falling GRMs: FY25 and 9M FY26 can be analysed together. In FY25, secularly all players saw EBITDA degrowth. Crude corrected a modest 5 per cent as against 14 per cent in FY24, aiding ONGC and OIL to post lower EBITDA degrowth compared with OMCs and refiners. As oil traded lower, the windfall tax on domestic crude was done away with. As for OMCs and refiners, the GRMs—benchmark-wise and for Indian players fell significantly—becoming half of FY24 margins for most players. For OMCs, the pain was accentuated by large LPG under-recoveries which ballooned to ₹41,000 crore combined, going by some reports. For context, the combined EBITDA of the three OMCs in FY24 (financially, a healthy year) was ₹1.4 lakh crore.

However, in 9M FY26, though crude corrected 17 per cent, tables turned for GRMs, especially in Q3 FY26, driven by rebound in crack spreads and demand-supply imbalances. EBITDA of all refiners grew healthily, though on the low base of 9M FY25. Moreover, the government, in August 2025, announced a ₹30,000 crore one-time compensation to OMCs in relation to the LPG under-recoveries suffered. This is payable in 12 instalments—₹12,500 crore in FY26 and ₹17,500 crore in FY27. With crude prices down, OIL’s EBITDA declined and so did for ONGC’s upstream business. Yet its refining operations aided the company post a 16 per cent EBITDA growth.

Shares of all players corrected in FY25 reacting to fundamentals and they bottomed out close to March 2025. With GRMs recovering in 9M FY26 and government’s compensation for under-recoveries, shares have rallied from these lows, only to hit a brick wall after the start of the US-Iran war.

Making sense of valuation

It is now established that the sector witnesses volatile earnings. Hence while P/E ratio is a useful metric, it can also be misleading many a times, especially for the OMCs. As can be seen from the charts, in their recent worse years, that is, FY23 and FY25, P/E multiples shot up abnormally. For instance, BPCL’s P/E went up to 35x by FY23-end and HPCL’s had a invalid P/E because of losses in that year. However, it is in these worse years, when P/E becomes expensive, that their price-to-book value (P/B) ratio is seen bottoming out. Sometimes the best opportunity to buy these stocks has been when their PE has been invalid or very high (see chart). Hence P/B becomes a more reliable valuation metric to understand where the stocks can bottom

out. At the end of the day, these are companies with hard, productive assets that have the potential to make hay when the sun shines. The P/B ratio at stocks’ bottom as given in the chart were as observed in FY23. The ratios bottomed in FY25 too, though not as deep as in FY23.

So, investors looking to make value bets on OMC stocks as soaring crude/marketing under recoveries take a toll on their profitability, need to consider their attractiveness as they trend closer to their prior bottoms in P/B multiples. The other stocks too will be volatile as different factors discussed above play out. The valuation range given in the charts can serve as useful guide to assess their attractiveness or lack of it.

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Where is oil headed in the medium term? In the answer to this lies the answer to where markets also could be headed. While there are many ways to assess this, none of which can enable us to forecast with certainty, they are still useful tools to consider making some decisions. One such tool is trying to interpret what the F&O market is indicating.

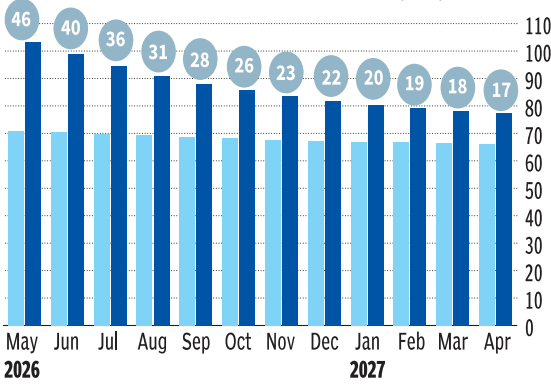
Crude oil futures are currently trading in steep backwardation, a market structure where near-term prices are higher than those of contracts farther out on the curve. For instance, Brent crude futures for May (the nearest active contract) and September are trading around \$103/barrel and \$88/barrel respectively. This is because, oil market participants like refiners and traders typically scramble to secure immediate barrels, pushing front-month prices sharply higher while the impact on later contracts remains relatively muted.

Backwardation generally indicates tight supply conditions in the immediate term, where buyers are willing to pay a premium to secure earliest delivery barrels. The structure suggests that the severe disruption in supply that is happening now, may be temporary rather than a prolonged structural shortage.

Before analysing what the current futures curve signals about the oil market, it is useful to briefly understand the concepts of contango and backwardation.

CONTANGO VS BACKWARDATION
In commodity markets, futures prices normally reflect the cost of carry, which includes storage, insurance and financing costs. Under such circumstances, contracts for later delivery tend to trade at higher prices than near-term contracts, resulting in an upward sloping futures curve. This structure is known as contango. Backwardation, on the other hand, occurs

Oil market in a visibly steep backwardation



*Brent Crude futures on Intercontinental Exchange

ALERTS.

Voice-based digital payments

PayU has partnered with CoRover.ai to make voice-based digital payments possible in over 100 Indian languages and dialects. Under this tie-up, PayU's payment system will work with CoRover's BharatGPT-based AI platform, letting users make payments through simple voice conversations, instead of typing. This is among the first such partnerships between an Indian AI model provider and a payment company for AI-powered payments, the companies said. One early use-case is voice-based UPI payments on Afterlife, a digital succession planning platform powered by CoRover's Voice AI. The two firms plan to expand this to more areas such as e-commerce, travel, OTT and banking. They will also explore features like UPI Circle and UPI Reserve Pay for AI-led transactions.

TAX QUERY



I am a regular applicant in main-board and SME IPOs. I usually exit on listing day after IPO share allotment. On the losses I experience from IPO punting, can I bunch them up with other short-term capital losses in equity cash and futures & options? Can they be set off against short-term gains?

Shankar Ghose

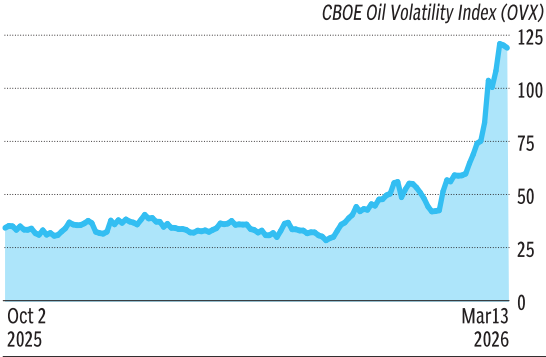
Listing-day sale of IPO allotted results in short-term capital gains / losses. Income-Tax Act allows for setting off short-term capital loss against short-term capital gains as well as against long-term capital gains. However, futures and options are normally taxed as business income. Further, setting off short-term capital loss against gains from trading in futures and options is not permitted.

The writer is Partner, Deloitte India
Send your queries to taxtalk@thehindu.co.in

The backwardation in oil futures and what to infer from it

LOOKING AHEAD. Such a structure usually emerges when the physical market tightens either due to a sudden spike in demand or an unexpected disruption in supply

Volatility in oil prices shoots through the roof



CBOE: Chicago Board Options Exchange

when futures prices decline, as one moves further along the curve. This results in a downward sloping futures curve. Such a structure usually emerges when the physical market tightens, either due to a sudden spike in demand or an unexpected disruption in supply. The present market structure reflects such a situation.

NEAR-TERM CONTRACTS SPIKE
The current supply concerns stem from the disruption in shipping through the Strait of Hormuz, one of

the most critical choke-points in the global oil trade.

Around 20 per cent of the world's crude oil flows through this narrow waterway, making it highly sensitive to geopolitical tensions. With Iran positioned along the Strait, the threat of attacks on oil tankers has forced vessels to avoid the route, effectively choking supply flows in the near term.

The geopolitical escalation intensified after the first strike on Iran on February 28. Following this, Brent crude futures surged past the \$100-a-barrel mark and touched multi-year highs. However, the magnitude of the rally varied significantly across different contracts.

The May contract rallied sharply to a high of \$119.50 on March 9, marking a 69 per cent jump from the closing price of \$70.84 on February 26. In comparison, the September contract rose to \$90.23, gaining 31 per cent, while the December contract climbed to \$82.35, registering an increase of 22 per cent.

Even after some correction, the gains remain uneven. As of March 13, the

May, September and December contracts were up 46 per cent, 28 per cent and 22 per cent respectively from their February levels. Plotting prices across all contracts up to March 2027 clearly reveals a steep backwardation.

TIME SPREADS SIGNAL TIGHTNESS

The steepness of the curve becomes clearer when examining time spreads, which measure the price difference between near-term and longer-dated contracts.

Currently, the May-September spread stands at about \$15 a barrel, while the May-December spread is roughly \$21. The difference widens further to about \$26 between May and April 2027 contracts. Such wide spreads suggest that the market is placing a substantial premium on immediate supply, indicating acute near-term tightness in the physical market.

The heightened uncertainty is also visible in options markets. The CBOE Oil Volatility Index (OVX) surged to 125.99 on March 12, reflecting extreme uncertainty in crude markets. For perspective, the OVX had earlier spiked to 102.01 in November 2021 following the discovery of the Omicron Covid variant and to 86.67 during the initial phase of the Russia-Ukraine war in early 2022.

TEMPORARY SUPPLY CONCERNS

The outperformance of near-term contracts relative to longer-dated ones points to a sharp shortage in prompt supply. This suggests that the market sees the current disruption as severe but concentrated in the near term and likely to

TAKE NOTE

Futures curves reflect current market expectations and risk premiums; they are indicators, not precise forecasts of future prices

ease in the coming months.

Forecasts from the US Energy Information Administration (EIA) broadly align with this interpretation. According to the EIA's latest Short-Term Energy Outlook, published on March 10, shut-in production due to the conflict is expected to peak in April. But the report forecast the supply to ease thereafter. However, this needs to be monitored given the level of uncertainty.

They also expect global oil production to outpace consumption in 2026 and 2027, despite the recent developments. Global oil inventories are projected to increase by about 1.9 million barrels per day in 2026 and 3 million barrels per day in 2027.

In fact, the EIA estimates excess crude production of 1.87 million barrels per day in 2026, and 3 million barrels per day in 2027. In 2025, supply exceeded demand by 2.37 million barrels per day.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR PRICE

If oil flows through the Strait of Hormuz normalise, the anticipated oversupply could exert downward pressure on crude prices. The EIA expects Brent crude to average around \$70/barrel in the fourth quarter of 2026 and \$64 in 2027.

On the other hand, the

futures curve indicates a higher price as October, November and December contracts are now trading above \$80/barrel.

That said, the outlook remains highly uncertain at the moment. If the conflict persists and supply disruptions continue, the futures curve could start flattening as markets begin to price in sustained higher prices for longer-dated contracts. But this is what the futures market is indicating for now.

bl. views

Rajesh Mediratta, MD & CEO, IGX, and Atanu Mukherjee, CEO, Dastur Energy, analyse India's response to fuel supply shocks. In a webinar moderated by businessline Resident Editor Richa Mishra, the speakers emphasise the urgent need for diversified sourcing and expanded strategic energy reserves.

Interest rates on home loans (%)

Institution	Loan amount		
	Under ₹30 lakh	₹30 to ₹75 lakh	Over ₹75 lakh
BANKS (Floating rates)			
Axis Bank	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10
Bank of Baroda	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95
Bank of India	7.10-10	7.10-10	7.10-10
Bank of Maharashtra	7.10-9.65	7.10-9.65	7.10-9.65
Canara Bank	7.15-10	7.10-10	7.05-9.90
Central Bank	7.10-8.70	7.10-8.70	7.10-8.70
DBS Bank	<=8.70	<=8.70	<=8.70
Dhanlaxmi Bank	8.20-12.0	8.20-12.0	8.20-12.0
Federal Bank	7.30-9.50	7.30-9.50	7.30-9.50
HDFC Bank	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20
ICICI Bank	>=7.45	>=7.45	>=7.45
Indian Bank	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55
IOB	7.10-8.20	7.10-8.20	7.10-8.20
IDBI Bank	7.35-11.95	7.35-11.95	7.35-11.95
J&K Bank	>= 7.25	>= 7.25	>= 7.25
Karnataka Bank	7.30-11.68	7.30-11.68	7.30-11.68
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Kotak Mahindra Bank	>=7.70	>=7.70	>=7.70
Punjab National Bank	7.25-9.0	7.20-9.0	7.20-9.0
Punjab & Sind Bank	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70
RBL Bank	>= 9.0	>= 9.0	>= 9.0
State Bank of India	7.25-8.45	7.25-8.45	7.25-8.45
South Indian Bank	>=7.20	>=7.20	>=7.20
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30
BANKS (Fixed rates)			
Canara Bank	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75
Bank of Baroda	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95
Indian Bank	9.25-9.45	9.25-9.45	9.25-9.45
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Floating rates)			
Tata Capital	>=7.50	>=7.50	>=7.50
PNB Housing	7.75-10.05	7.60-10.05	7.50-9.95
Central Bank Housing	10-12.85	10-12.85	10-12.35
Samman Capital	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
Aditya Birla Housing Fin	>=7.75	>=7.75	>=7.75
Bajaj Finserv	7.15-20	7.15-20	7.15-20
GIC Housing Finance	>=8.80	>=8.80	>=8.80
Sundaram Home Finance *	>=10.65	>=10.65	>=10.65
Piramal Finance Limited	>=9.99	>=9.99	>=9.99
IIFL Home Finance	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
LIC Housing Finance	7.15-9.65	7.15-9.75	7.15-10.10
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Fixed rates)			
LIC Housing Finance	10-10.25	10-10.25	10-10.25

Rates that vary with tenures or credit score within the specified loan amounts are indicated as a range. Fixed interest rates may be subject to a revision after a specified tenure. Rates may also apply only for a definite period and change to floating thereafter. Data taken from respective bank's website as on Mar 13, 2026. Contributed by BankBazaar.com. * Annual percentage rate;

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A reputed EPS Thermocol Manufacturing Unit located in Fab City, Hyderabad is available for immediate sale. This is a running business with a production capacity of 120 Tonnes per month and well-established operations. The factory is equipped with the necessary production facilities and is currently serving reputable existing customers with well-defined, consistent production plans. Interested parties may contact for further details and site visit. Contact: fabcity@zohomail.in 97399 07043 / 98493 00209

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Phone : +91-120-6102000/6102009 CIN: U40101UP2007PLC032835

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Prayagraj Power Generation Company Limited invites expression of interest (EOI) from eligible vendors for **Below Packages** of 3x660 MW Thermal Power Plant at Prayagraj Power Generation Company Limited, Bara, Dist. Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh, India.

1) Procurement of Sodium Hypo Chloride (PPGCL/FY26/DJ/PPGCL/972_1000007339).
2) Ventilation Duct Fabrication and Erection (PPGCL/FY26/DJ/PPGCL/973_3000000500).

Details of pre-qualification requirements, bid security, purchasing of tender document etc. may be downloaded using the URL- <https://www.ppgcl.co.in/tenders.php> Eligible vendors willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee for issue of bid document latest by **18th March 2026**.

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(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

The Tata Power Company Limited invites tenders from eligible vendors for the following package (Two Part Bidding) in Mumbai.
A) Civil works for GIS building at Tata Power Badalapur Receiving Station. (Package Ref: CC26SVP049).
Interested & eligible bidders for above package to submit Tender Fee, Authorization Letter before 15:00 Hrs. **Monday, 23rd March 2026**.
For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. For detailed NIT, please visit Tender section on website <https://www.tatapower.com>. Also, all future corrigendum's if any, to the said tender will be published on Tender section of above website (Tata Power → Business Associates → Tender Documents) only.

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Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

Indian equity markets have been in an indecisive phase over the past 15–18 months. After the sharp correction that began in September 2024, broader market indices have largely oscillated within a range, offering little conviction to investors either way. In this backdrop, many investors prefer to temporarily step aside and wait for the market to give a green signal before deploying fresh money.

For investors wanting to deploy funds for about a year while earning better returns than a savings account, several categories of debt-oriented mutual funds and hybrid funds offer viable options. These funds prioritise liquidity, relatively low volatility and modest returns, making them suitable for parking money while waiting for opportunities in the equity market. The most relevant categories include arbitrage funds, liquid and overnight funds, ultra-short duration funds, low-duration funds and money market funds.

These funds can also be useful for investors who plan to gradually shift into equity funds through systematic transfer plans (STPs). However, portfolio quality, expense ratio and exit load are key factors investors should examine before investing in these funds.

ARBITRAGE FUNDS
Arbitrage funds exploit price differences between the cash market and the futures market. For instance, if a stock trades at ₹100 in the cash market and ₹101 in the futures market, the fund buys the stock in the cash segment and simultaneously sells the futures contract. When the contract expires, the price difference is locked in as profit. These funds also employ index futures and covered call strategies. Because these trades are hedged, arbitrage funds carry very limited directional equity risk. Returns largely depend on the arbitrage spreads available in the market and short-term interest rates.

The key advantage is tax treatment. Since these funds maintain equity exposure above 65 per cent through hedged positions, they are taxed as equity funds. If held for more than one year, gains qualify for long-term capital gains taxation.

Performance, measured by one-year rolling returns calculated from the last five years of direct plans, shows that funds in this category delivered an average return of 5.9 per cent. Their one-year returns ranged between 2 per cent and 8.3 per cent during the period.

Why it’s time to exit this large-cap fund

FUND CALL. Axis Large Cap has been a lackadaisical performer in the segment over medium and long terms

Venkatasubramanian K
bl. research bureau

In the current bout of market volatility following the war situation in West Asia, even large-cap indices have seen significant corrections.

Frontline indices across market caps have fallen 14–20 per cent from their recent highs.

Though many large-cap stocks have declined in the last year or so, in general, these names are relied upon for portfolio stability and steady returns over the long term. More so in the case of large-cap mutual funds.

Though many active large-cap funds have struggled to beat the Nifty 100 TRI or the BSE 100 TRI, some schemes still managed to deliver steady outperformance over the long term.

Given that it is the key category that must figure in most investor portfolios, fund selection becomes important. Prolonged underperformers must be weeded out of the portfolio.

In this regard, Axis Large Cap (Axis Bluechip earlier) has been a lackadaisical performer in the segment over the medium and long terms.

Investors can consider moving out of the scheme and switching to better funds in the category.

UNDERWHELMING SHOW
Axis Large Cap has found it challenging to beat standard large-cap benchmarks across timeframes over the past several years. Over one, three, five and seven-year timeframes, the fund has underperformed the Nifty 100 TRI by 0.5–2.6 percentage points.



Top performing funds		1-year rolling return (CAGR %)*		
Fund	bl.portfolio star rating	Minimum	Maximum	Average
Arbitrage Funds				
Invesco India Arbitrage	-	4.4	8.9	7.1
Kotak Arbitrage	-	4.1	9.0	7.0
Liquid Funds				
Quant Liquid	-	4.0	7.4	6.0
Edelweiss Liquid	-	3.4	7.5	5.7
Ultra Short Duration Funds				
Aditya Birla SL Savings	5	3.8	8.5	6.8
Nippon India US Duration	5	4.6	8.8	7.2
Low Duration Funds				
UTI Low Duration	5	3.8	9.5	7.3
Axis Treasury Advantage	4	3.5	8.9	6.8
Money Market Funds				
Nippon India Money Market	5	3.7	8.5	6.8
ICICI Pru Money Market	4	3.5	8.5	6.7

Note: *rolling returns were calculated from the last 5-years NAV data. Liquid and arbitrage funds have not been rated, as most of them tend to deliver similar returns most of the time Source: ACEMF As of March 21, 2026.

Investors should note that arbitrage spreads can compress when liquidity in the derivatives market tightens. Therefore, returns can vary depending on market conditions. Still, for investors looking to park money for about 12 months, arbitrage funds remain one of the most tax-efficient options. Expense ratios for regular plans range from 0.6 to 1.6 per cent, while direct plans typically charge between 0.1 and 0.4 per cent. Exit loads range from nil to about 0.5 per cent for holding periods between seven days and one month.

LIQUID, OVERNIGHT
Liquid funds invest in money market instruments such as treasury bills, commercial papers and certificates of deposit with maturities of up to 91 days. These funds also offer an instant redemption facility that enables investors to withdraw a portion

of their investment, usually up to ₹50,000 or 90 per cent of the folio value (whichever is lower), with funds credited to the bank account within minutes through IMPS. The performance of liquid funds largely tracks short-term interest rates in the economy. Based on one-year rolling returns over the past five years for direct plans, the category delivered an average return of 5.6 per cent. Returns ranged between 2.9 per cent and 7.5 per cent during the period. Expense ratios for regular plans range from 0.13 to 0.54 per cent, while direct plans typically charge between 0.06 and 0.23 per cent. Exit loads are usually minimal, up to about 0.007 per cent for holdings redeemed within seven days. Overnight funds, similar to liquid funds, invest in securities that mature in one day. Because the maturity is extremely short, these funds carry minimal interest-rate risk or credit risk.

BRIEF STAY

- Arbitrage funds offer equity taxation with low volatility
- Liquid and overnight funds offer a cash-like parking avenue
- Ultra short duration funds balance returns and stability

They are widely used by institutions and treasury managers for very short-term parking of funds. However, liquid funds typically offer slightly higher returns than overnight funds while still maintaining high liquidity and relatively low volatility.

ULTRA-SHORT DURATION
Ultra-short duration funds invest in instruments with a Macaulay duration of three to six months. Because they take slightly higher duration exposure than liquid funds, they may offer marginally better yields. These funds typically invest in high-quality corporate bonds, commercial papers and money market instruments. The short maturity profile ensures that interest-rate changes do not significantly erode returns over short holding periods.

Performance measured by one-year rolling returns over the last five years for direct plans shows that the category delivered an average return of 6.6 per cent.

Their one-year returns ranged between 3 per cent and 8.8 per cent during the period. Expense ratios for regular plans range from 0.3 to 1.4 per cent, while direct plans typically charge between 0.13 and 0.5 per

cent. Exit loads are generally nil across most funds in the category, according to ACEMF data. However, investors should pay close attention to portfolio quality. Credit events in debt funds in the past have highlighted the importance of choosing funds that emphasise high-rated instruments and maintain a conservative portfolio construction.

LOW-DURATION
Low-duration funds extend the maturity profile further, with Macaulay duration typically ranging between six and 12 months. These funds invest across corporate bonds, government securities and money market instruments.

Because of the slightly longer duration, they are somewhat more sensitive to interest-rate movements than ultra-short duration funds. Performance measured by one-year rolling returns over the last five years for direct plans shows that the category delivered an average return of 6.8 per cent. Their one-year returns ranged between 2.5 per cent and 9.5 per cent during the period. Expense ratios for regular plans range from 0.4 to 1.2 per cent, while direct plans typically charge between 0.17 and 0.46 per cent. Exit loads are generally nil across funds in this category, according to ACEMF data. As with other debt funds, investors should pay close attention to portfolio quality.

MONEY MARKET FUNDS
Money market funds focus on investing in high-quality money market instruments such as treasury bills, commercial papers and certificates of deposit with maturities of up to one year. Compared with liquid funds, money market funds may generate slightly higher returns by taking exposure to instruments with somewhat longer maturities. However, they still maintain relatively low interest-rate sensitivity. Performance measured by one-year rolling returns over the past five years for direct plans shows that the category delivered an average return of 6.6 per cent. Their one-year returns ranged between 3 per cent and 8.6 per cent during the period.

Expense ratios for regular plans range from 0.22 to 0.9 per cent, while direct plans typically charge between 0.08 and 0.25 per cent. Exit loads are generally nil across funds in the category, per ACEMF data.

For debt funds, gains are added to the investor's income and taxed at the applicable slab rate (for investments made after April 2023). The table lists the top-performing funds based on one-year rolling returns across the aforementioned categories.

ALERTS.

Groww MF launches Nifty PSU Bank ETF

Groww Mutual Fund (MF) has launched Groww Nifty PSU Bank ETF, an open ended scheme tracking the Nifty PSU Bank Index – TRI. The NFO closes on March 20, 2026. The entry load is not applicable and the exit load is nil. The minimum subscription amount is ₹500 and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter. The performance will be benchmarked against Nifty PSU Bank Index - TRI; its fund managers are Nikhil Satam, Aakash Chauhan and Shashi Kumar. The objective is to generate long-term capital growth by investing in securities of the Nifty PSU Bank Index in the same proportion/weightage to provide returns before expenses that track the total return of Nifty PSU Bank Index, subject to tracking errors.

Mirae Asset MF launches Silver ETF FOF

Mirae Asset Mutual Fund launched Mirae Asset Silver ETF FOF, an open-ended fund of fund investing in units of Mirae Asset Silver ETF. The NFO closes on March 18, 2026.Entry load is not applicable. Exit load will be 0.05 per cent if redeemed or switched out within 15 calendar days from the date of allotment and nil if redeemed or switched out after 15 days. The minimum subscription amount is ₹5,000 per application and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter. The performance of the Scheme will be benchmarked to Domestic Price of Physical Silver (based on London Bullion Market association (LBMA) silver daily spot fixing price).

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price				
	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
	as on March 13			
ETF				
DSP Nifty Midcap 150 ETF	20.3	22.9	8.4	1,945
HDFC Nifty 100 ETF	24.5	26.1	0.7	1,102
MIRAE Nifty 8-13Y GSEC ETF	30.0	30.1	0.4	105
Mirae NYSE FANG+ ETF	132.7	162.3	0.3	1,824
Zerodha Nifty 8-13 YR ETF	30.0	30.0	0.3	774
ICICI Nifty 5 YR G-SEC ETT	64.6	64.7	0.2	295
Nippon ETF Nifty 8-13 GSEC	29.5	29.4	0.2	16,485
GOLD ETFs				
Edelweiss Gold ETF	157.8	157.8	0.0	213
Zerodha Gold ETF	24.8	24.8	-0.1	85,274
Baroda BNPP Gold ETF	152.5	153.0	-0.1	217

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on March 13, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 10-year CAGR					
Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on March 13	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension	51	14	12	14	75,761
Kotak Pension	65	15	12	14	4,578
ICICI Pru Pension	70	15	12	14	27,525
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension	31	8	7	9	8,462
SBI Pension	41	8	6	8	27,593
HDFC Pension	28	7	6	8	50,186
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension	30	8	7	9	31,632
ICICI Pru Pension	45	8	7	8	12,907
SBI Pension	45	8	7	8	14,642
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension	44	14	12	14	1,836
ICICI Pru Pension	55	15	12	14	773
Kotak Pension	57	15	12	14	224

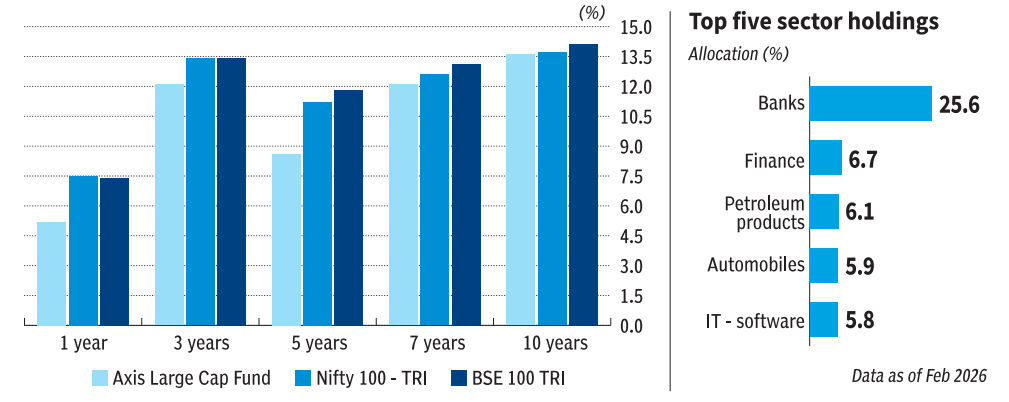
*Source: NPS Trust. Returns as on March 13, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns						
AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)			
			1-year	3-year	5-year	
LARGE CAP						
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	288	26.8	24.0	22.8	
ICICI Pru	Largecap	882	24.9	23.7	20.2	
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	21.4	21.9	17.3	
Ksema Wealth	Alpha	16	24.4	19.5	16.4	
MULTI CAP						
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	118	19.1	32.9	25.9	
ICICI Pru	Largecap	1,077	31.1	30.1	25.6	
Shepherd's Hill Financial Advisors	Value Magno	118	23.9	32.4	24.9	
Bonanza Portfolio	Edge	NA	10.2	22.3	24.8	
Invasset	Growth Pro Max	359	11.3	36.7	24.6	
Buoyant Capital	Opportunities	9,127	30.1	26.1	24.2	
MID-CAP						
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	12.3	18.1	19.1	
Master Portfolio Services	Master Trust India Growth	346	20.0	16.2	19.0	
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	12.2	17.8	18.2	
Sundaram Alternate Assets	SELF Portfolio	NA	35.8	22.6	17.3	
SMALL CAP						
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	4,457	61.8	51.5	46.6	
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	793	-0.2	22.8	37.4	
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,108	-5.3	31.2	25.1	
Accuracap	Dynamo	13	13.3	29.7	23.6	

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on February 28, 2026

Underperforming benchmarks across timelines



Source: ACE MF, Valueresearch; CAGR data for direct plan as of Mar 12, 2026

indicating that the scheme's NAV falls more than the benchmark during periods of corrections. A score of 100 indicates that a fund performs exactly in line with its benchmark. This inference is based on data from March 2021–March 2026. All return figures and the ratios pertain to the direct plan of the fund.

PORTFOLIO MOVES
Axis Large Cap invests in line with the mandate for the category. Most of the times, the large-cap portion in the portfolio is in excess of 90 per cent.

However, the fund does take significant cash and derivatives exposures, which though insulates the portfolio during falls, could result in lower returns during rallies.

Cash and cash equivalents and net current assets, derivatives (futures) and treasury bills have sometimes gone above 10 per cent of the portfolio.

In terms of sector preferences, financial services (including banking) have been the top

holdings across timelines. However, higher weightage to the likes of underperforming stocks such as HDFC Bank, Kotak Mahindra Bank, Bajaj Finance etc. resulted in modest returns.

Though the fund pared exposure to the IT sector, it had heavy exposure in 2025 with Infosys and TCS being among key holdings. The general roiling of domestic software firms and the lower growth recorded by the majors, and AI-led business disruptions in the segment have resulted in their prices coming off sharply over the past 18 months.

In the past, exposure to retailing giant Avenue Supermarkets and automobile major tata Motors have hurt returns, though here again exposures are pared.

In its recent portfolio, auto and auto components, healthcare and oil, gas & consumable fuels figure among the top holdings.

Axis Large Cap fund's top 10 stocks account for more than 50 per cent of the portfolio and generally make for concentrated

Blending growth and efficiency

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl, research bureau

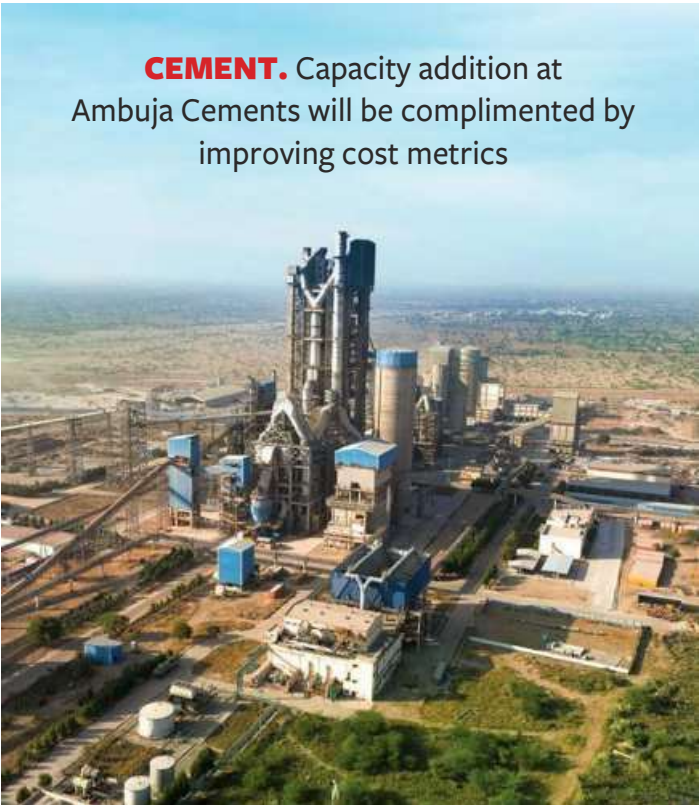
The stock of Ambuja Cements (a Adani Group company) has been under pressure from weak results in Q3FY26 and this has been further amplified by the ongoing US-Iran conflict. The stock, trading at 12.6 times one-year forward EV/EBITDA, is at a 17 per cent discount to the last five-year average. In this context, long-term investors can accumulate the stock on dips. Going forward the company plans to focus on cost efficiencies, while its expansion target remains on track. Of the two areas of focus — volume growth and cost efficiency, the latter requires higher conviction before the consensus factors it into valuations. Hence stock may take time to play out and accumulating on dips will offer better margin of safety.

VOLUME GROWTH

In May 2022, Adani Group acquired controlling stakes in Ambuja Cements and ACC for ₹81,000 crore. Ambuja Cements which already owns 50.05 per cent stake in ACC is now in the process of amalgamating the company with itself. With a capacity of 67 mtpa (million tonnes per annum) at the time, the acquisition price was around \$157 EV per tonne. The combined capacity has increased to 109 mtpa as of December 2025 and is currently trading around \$120 EV per tonne. This includes organic expansion and acquisitions of Sanghi (acquired at EV per tonne of \$100), Penna (\$90 per tonne) and Orient (\$113 per tonne)—which is the most recent in April 2025.

The company intends to reach 155 mtpa by March 2028 with milestones of 115 mtpa by the fiscal-end and 130-132 mtpa by FY27-end.

The expansion plan also involves 15-mtpa capacity unlocked by debottlenecking at a relatively-lower cost of \$48 per tonne. Ambuja Cements plans to spend ₹8,000 crore per year on expansion both organically and inorganically.



COST EFFICIENCY

The company has not implemented an efficiency programme during FY24-9MFY26, which is reflected in the flat trend of cost per tonne, as shown in the figure. In Q3FY26, owing to branding, one-time plant maintenance costs and closure of old units, the costs spiked 6 per cent on a quarter-on-quarter basis. The management has mentioned that company has returned to normal range of costs in January operations after the one-time costs.

But in the long run, Ambuja Cements aims to lower operational costs by 5 per cent per year in FY27 and FY28, which should improve EBITDA per tonne by 30-40 per cent by FY28. The levers include power, fuel, logistics and raw materials.

The company intends to lower power costs by ₹100-125 per tonne through renewable energy inclusion compared to the current cost break-up of ₹4,576 per tonne in 9MFY26. It has a current capacity of 900 MW, which contributes to 37

per cent power consumption and is expected to touch 60 per cent by FY28. With sharply lower cost of solar panels the target should be within reach.

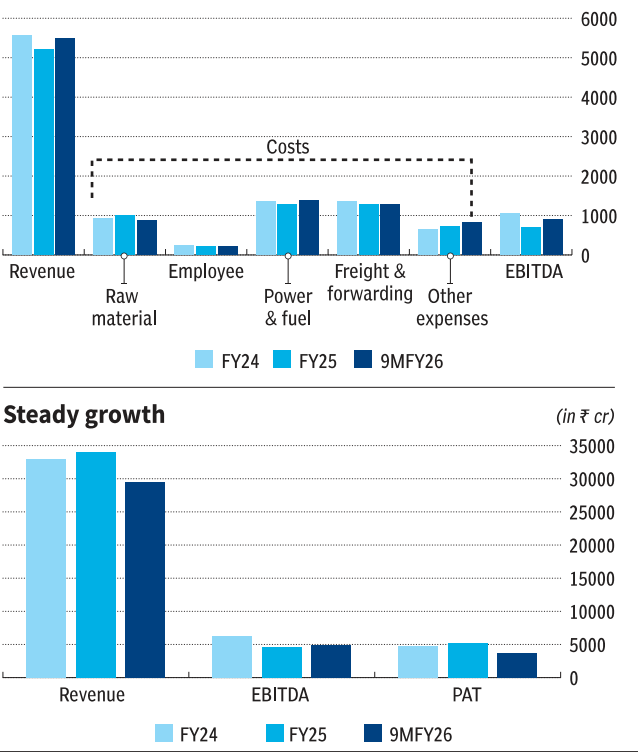
Fuel costs are targeted to be reduced by ₹150 per tonne owing to better utilisation of fuel in newly-added plants. The company is setting up grinding units too as a part of expansion, which should target lower logistics costs by ₹100-125 per tonne, along with wider presence of the consolidated entity from the recent acquisitions. The large operational capacity and an integrated platform, which the company has operationalised, should deliver lower raw material costs along with other operational efficiencies.

It intends to invest ₹2,000 crore for these projects in FY27 and a similar run-rate can be expected in FY28 as well.

FINANCIALS, VALUATION

As mentioned, Ambuja Cements is trading at a 17 per cent discount to a five-year average of 15 times one-year forward EV/

Financial metrics



● ACCUMULATE ON DIPS

Ambuja Cements
₹425.6

WHY

- Capacity addition on track
- Cost efficiencies planned not yet factored in estimates
- Reasonable valuations

EBITDA. Even on a replacement basis of EV/tonne, the company with more than 100-mtpa capacity is trading at \$120 per tonne—which is closer to mid-sized players with 8-10 mtpa capacity. The recent quarter's miss on cost efficiency coupled with concerns on energy prices due to the war have impacted the stock.

On the energy front, cement production uses coal for fuel, electricity for power, and freight costs are influenced by petrol/

diesel prices. The three factors so far have been insulated by energy price volatility. Coal, a leading cost, has been on a downward trajectory since 2022-23, declining from \$650 per tonne at peak to \$180-190 per tonne in December before recovering to \$210 per tonne now.

Consensus estimates are pointing to a 16 per cent revenue CAGR in FY25-28. This indicates a healthy but conservative estimate of capacity addition to 140-142 mtpa by FY28, based on our assumption of 2-3 per cent annual cement price growth and 75 per cent capacity utilisation. But EBITDA margin estimates at 21 per cent in FY28 is indicating only a marginal cost per tonne improvement of ₹50-80 per tonne compared to company estimates of ₹400-500 per tonne by FY28 from FY25.

Ambuja Cements' lower valuation on conservative growth estimates provides a decent margin of safety in the current period for investors to opportunistically accumulate the stock on corrections.

Luxury at a discount

HOSPITALITY.

Further corrections in IHCL can offer patient long-term investors a reasonable entry into this hotels leader

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl, research bureau

Our September-2025 'book profit' call on Tata Group-backed Indian Hotels Co Ltd (IHCL) at ₹778 argued that while the company remained a strong hospitality play, valuations at 46 times FY27 estimated earnings left limited room for upside. That caution broadly worked. The stock has since corrected to ₹610, down nearly 22 per cent from our earlier call and about 29 per cent from 52-week peak of ₹858.85 (BSE). With the FY27 forward P/E now easing to 38 times, a meaningful valuation gap has opened up versus the earlier call. Against this backdrop, we believe long-term investors can consider accumulating the stock on dips.

However, there are risks worth noting. The ongoing West Asia conflict can weigh on foreign tourist arrivals, travel sentiment and hospitality demand. LPG supply disruptions have also emerged as a near-term operational concern for parts of the food services ecosystem including hotels. Legal overhangs such as the Mumbai Port Trust dispute and the Taj Lands End property-tax penalty claim also remain. Even so, IHCL remains India's largest hospitality player (32,300 rooms), with a broad multi-brand platform, a largely capital-light pipeline (94 per cent), strong liquidity and double-digit medium-term growth visibility. The management remains confident of double-digit revenue growth. While FY27 earnings growth estimates are not explosive, the current derating offers patient investors a better long-term entry window into a quality franchise and industry pioneer.

BUSINESS

While the IHCL journey began with The Taj Mahal Palace, Mumbai, in 1903, the company today is less a pure hotel owner and more a scaled hospitality platform with multiple earnings levers. Taj continues to anchor the premium/luxury end (upwards of ₹20,000/night), but the

● **ACCUMULATE ON DIPS**

Indian Hotels ₹609.8

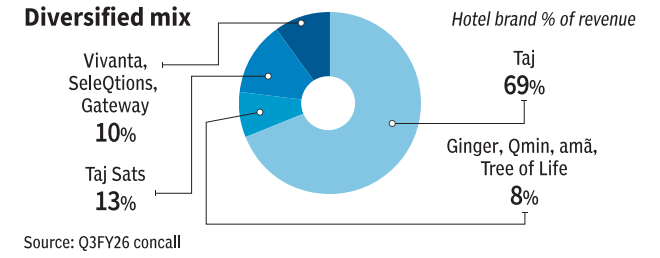
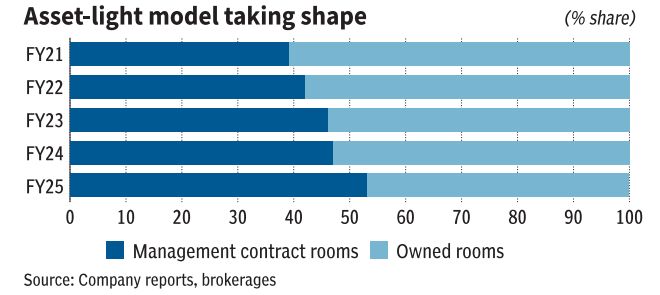
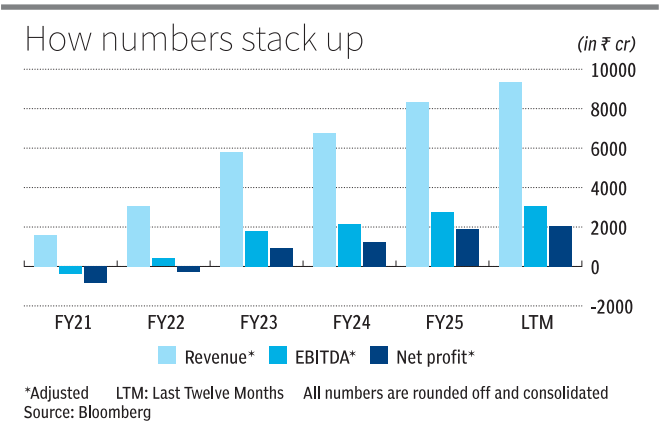
WHY

- Correction improves long-term risk-reward
- Capital-light pipeline supports scalable growth
- Market leadership and strong cash flows

larger story is that IHCL is no longer dependent on one segment or one customer profile. It now straddles boutique luxury (Claridges), boutique leisure (Tree of Life), upper upscale (SeleQtions, Vivanta, Gateway), mid-scale (Ginger), premium home-stays (amā Stays & Trails), experiential stays (Brij), wellness (Atmanan) and food-linked adjacencies (Taj Sats, Qmin), giving it a wider revenue base and better ability to navigate through cycles.

IHCL's platform now spans more than 617 hotels, with a large pipeline executable over the next few years (over 30,200 rooms/256 hotels) that is overwhelmingly capital light, helping growth without stretching the balance sheet in the same way as a traditional ownership-led model. By Q3FY26-end, IHCL has 67 per cent capital-light exposure. That is one reason adjusted EBITDA margins (over 30 per cent in the last three fiscals) have held up well and why investors continue to assign the stock a premium versus peers.

Just as important, the company's newer engines are becoming meaningful. Ginger's expansion is turning IHCL into a stronger mid-market player (₹2,500-5,500/night), competing with the likes of Lemon Tree, Bloom, Fab Hotels etc., while management fees and ancillary streams (Taj Sats) are adding quality to earnings. Recent acquisitions fit this broader platform logic. ANK Hotels (Clarks) and Pride Hospitality deepen the Ginger-led mid-scale push,



Brij expands boutique leisure & Atmantan opens a high-margin entry into luxury wellness.

FINANCIALS

IHCL's reported financial performance for Q3FY26 and 9MFY26 indicates that the business, majorly domestic-driven, continues to grow at a healthy pace, even as the base has become larger. In Q3FY26, total revenue rose 12 per cent year on year to ₹2,900 crore. Half of the revenue comes from rooms, 35 per cent from F&B, 8 per cent from management fees and the rest from others. Revenue per available room grew 9 per cent in Q3FY26, on the back of 78 per cent occupancy (average room rate ₹17,700). For the first nine months of FY26, total revenue grew 17 per cent to ₹7,127 crore.

This suggests that demand conditions remain supportive.

On the operating side, EBITDA rose 11 per cent year on year in Q3FY26 to ₹1,134 crore, while for 9MFY26, it increased 16 per cent to ₹2,425 crore. Raw material costs, payroll costs, licence fee and power costs were all stable. Profit before tax and exceptional items rose 11 per cent in the quarter and 17 per cent over the nine-month period, pointing to continued strength in the core business. Reported PAT rose sharply in the quarter, aided by exceptional items (like sale of stake in Taj GVK Hotels), but even excluding those gains, the underlying earnings trajectory remains positive. To get a sense of historical annual earnings, see chart.

IHCL has gross cash of about

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

Sensex ups & downs

	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	Mar 6	Mar 13		
NTPC	380.5	384.5	↑	1.1
Power Grid	299.2	300.7	↑	0.5
Sun Pharma	1799.0	1800.5	↑	0.1
Tech Mahindra	1332.1	1332.0	↓	0.0
Reliance Industries	1405.2	1380.6	↓	-1.8
HCL Tech	1356.9	1325.5	↓	-2.3
ITC	309.8	301.5	↓	-2.7
HUL	2226.1	2160.6	↓	-2.9
Bharti Airtel	1871.5	1803.6	↓	-3.6
Asian Paints	2279.8	2196.3	↓	-3.7
Titan	4240.4	4071.6	↓	-4.0
ICICI Bank	1313.4	1254.3	↓	-4.5
Infosys	1308.3	1248.5	↓	-4.6
HDFC Bank	857.1	817.0	↓	-4.7
TCS	2557.7	2410.3	↓	-5.8
Bharat Electronics	468.4	439.6	↓	-6.1
Trent	3722.5	3490.4	↓	-6.2
Eternal	232.2	216.0	↓	-7.0
Bajaj Finserv	1869.2	1738.6	↓	-7.0
Tata Steel	198.5	183.4	↓	-7.6
Adani Ports & SEZ	1476.8	1363.6	↓	-7.7
Kotak Mahindra Bank	400.0	366.7	↓	-8.3
SBI	1143.6	1046.8	↓	-8.5
Axis Bank	1315.9	1197.3	↓	-9.0
Bajaj Finance	950.0	855.1	↓	-10.0
Tata Motors PV	350.7	314.3	↓	-10.4
Maruti Suzuki	14149.2	12588.5	↓	-11.0
M & M	3333.7	2951.2	↓	-11.5
UltraTech Cement	11986.8	10607.0	↓	-11.5
L&T	3948.9	3441.0	↓	-12.9

How sectoral indices moved

	Mar 6	Mar 13	Movement	% change
POWER	6,872	6,922	↑	0.7
HEALTHCARE	43,558	42,788	↓	-1.8
IT	29,219	28,152	↓	-3.7
FMCG	18,279	17,573	↓	-3.9
TECK	15,443	14,831	↓	-4.0
CONSUMER DURABLES	57,385	55,012	↓	-4.1
CAPITAL GOODS	70,618	67,620	↓	-4.2
REALTY	5,770	5,521	↓	-4.3
PSU	21,815	20,865	↓	-4.4
OIL&GAS	28,161	26,864	↓	-4.6
METALS	39,598	37,269	↓	-5.9
BANKEX	64,991	60,463	↓	-7.0
AUTO	59,830	53,877	↓	-9.9

How other indices moved

NIFTY NEXT 50	67,477	64,691	↓	-4.1
NIFTY 500	22,481	21,391	↓	-4.8
NIFTY 200	13,706	13,018	↓	-5.0
NIFTY 100	25,135	23,849	↓	-5.1
BANK NIFTY	57,783	53,758	↓	-7.0

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 I will soon complete 10 years since my listing. But my founder's entrepreneurial journey began around the time of Indian Independence and is now being managed by the third generation.
- 2 Half my revenues are domestic and the other half is equally divided across Asia and the rest of the world.
- 3 Just 10 clients make up more than 80 per cent of revenues.
- 4 While I have delivered about 15 per cent CAGR to shareholders since listing, my share price has had almost 50 per cent decline thrice during this period.
- 5 For a company of my size with a free float of just about ₹500 crore, I have unusually-high shareholder count of about 50,000.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by

UNIFI CAPITAL

Last week's stock:
Thiurmalai Chemicals
Last week's winner:
Mayank Malhotra

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,151) and Nifty Bank (53,758) cracked 5.3 per cent and 7 per cent respectively last week. The chart and the derivatives data suggest the downtrend may not be over yet. Here is our analysis:

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (March) (23,199), after opening with a gap-down last Monday, attempted a recovery. However, it faced a hurdle at 24,400 and resumed the decline. The contract breached the support at 24,000 and saw a deeper decline. By ending at 23,199 on Friday, it lost 5.5 per cent for the week.

There are no signs of a bullish trend reversal on the chart yet. While there is a likelihood for Nifty futures to retest 24,400, we expect the contract to see one more fall and extend the ongoing downtrend to 22,700. Subsequent support is at 22,200.

That said, if the contract breaks out of 24,400, it can extend the rally to 24,850. Only a decisive breach of 25,000 can turn the outlook bullish.

Substantiating the bearish view, Nifty futures witnessed considerable short build-up over the past week. As the contract slipped 5.5 per cent, the outstanding open interest of the March contract increased from 157 lakh contracts to nearly 200 lakh contracts.

With respect to options, the Put Call Ratio (PCR) of March and April monthly contracts stood at 1 and 0.90 respectively on Friday. Yet, over the past week, there has been a relatively greater number of call selling compared to puts in both March and April contracts, showing a bearish inclination.



Bear the brunt

F&O TRACKER. Charts and derivatives data point to continuation of downtrend

Overall, the prevailing downtrend is intact and the bears can drag Nifty futures further before it can establish a sustainable rally.

Strategy: Sell Nifty futures (March) if it rises to 23,750 for a better risk-reward ratio. Place stop-loss at 24,200. When the contract falls to 23,000 after the trade is initiated, revise the stop-loss to 23,500. Exit at 22,700.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (March) (53,923), too, began last Monday's session with a gap-down. After a failed attempt to recover, the contract saw a sharp fall. It broke below a key support at 55,000 and closed the week at 53,923, losing 7.2 per cent.

Wrapping up the week near the lowest traded level indicates strong selling pressure on the contract. But note that the price

- BROAD TREND**
- Short build-up on Nifty and Nifty Bank futures
 - Selling of calls exceeded puts in both indices
 - Traders can initiate fresh short trades on a rally

band of 53,500-54,000 is a considerable base, which can aid Nifty Bank futures in turning the direction upwards. However, such an uptick can be short-lived given the overall weakness in the market.

So going ahead, Nifty Bank futures might rally to 55,400 and then see another leg of downtrend. Such a fall can drag the contract below the support at 53,500 and take it to the 51,850-52,000 price region.

In line with the bearish indica-

tions, Nifty Bank futures saw fresh short build-up during the last week. While the price dropped by 7.2 per cent, the outstanding open interest of March contract increased from 21.5 lakh contracts to 22.6 lakh contracts.

Option traders too seem to expect further decline as selling of call options exceeded that of put options in the past week. Traders sell calls when they are bearish.

Considering the prevailing price action and how futures and options data look, the probability for a decline is high. But there could be a corrective rise on the back of the base ahead at 53,500.

Strategy: Stay out for now and short Nifty Bank futures when it rises to 55,400. Place stop-loss at 56,750. When the contract drops to 53,500 after the position has been initiated, alter the stop-loss to 54,000. Exit at 51,850.

Short call vs bear call spread

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. The latter has lower margin requirements than the former

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Short call option positions expose traders to high risk. NSE, therefore, requires traders to post margins to reduce the risk of default. These margin requirements significantly reduce if a trader has a long position that covers the naked short. A bear call spread, which involves a short lower strike call and a long higher strike call, will have lower margins than a naked short call. This week, we compare these two positions to see which position is optimal for a given view on an underlying.



TIP
Short call positions require margins because of high gamma risk

MARGIN STRATEGY
Suppose you short a call option on the Nifty Index. The next-week 23950 Nifty call trades at 425 and requires a margin of about 2.25 lakh. What if you instead go short on the 23950 strike and long on the 24400 strike? This bear call spread can be set up for a net credit of 217 points. You will have to post a margin of 63000, a significant margin reduction of 1.62 lakh. The flipside is that your maximum gain will also be lower (217

points against 425 points on the naked short position).

Is it optimal to give-up 208 points to save 1.62 lakh margin? It would be, if this capital is deployed in another trade, and the gain you expect from the trade is more than the points you gave up (208 points) to save the trading capital. But this argument presupposes that you have identified another trading opportunity

when you set up the bear call spread. What if are unable to find one? The argument would be that you will park the saved margin amount in an interest-bearing instrument till the time you deploy the capital.

You must, therefore, compare the return on that instrument with the return given up by initiating the spread. If the return on the instrument is higher, then the spread is an optimal choice. Note that the argument is based on a premise that you are setting up the spread with a sole objective of saving on the margin so that the capital can be deployed elsewhere. The motivation for

the bear call spread is not to reduce the greater risk in the naked short call. This assumption is reasonable because experienced traders who short can manage the position with strict stop limits.

OPTIONAL READING
Options on the Nifty Index are cash-settled. Nevertheless, short call positions require margins because of high gamma risk; a sharp increase in the underlying price can lead to increase in option price because of change in delta accelerated by the gamma. This margin requirement should not be confused for the margins collected to manage delivery risk. Those margins are imposed by your broker on open long positions starting four days before expiry on in-the-money (ITM) equity options. Finally, note that margin payments do not increase your transaction cost, but affects your cash flows. Comparing bear call spread with naked short call is about the opportunity cost associated with the strategy.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Signs of weakness

BULLION CUES. Gold, silver futures tests a base

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Gold (\$5,021/ounce) and silver (\$80.60/ounce) fell 2.9 per cent and 4.5 per cent respectively over the last week. In the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,58,466/10gm) lost 2 per cent whereas silver futures (₹2,59,435/kg) was down 3.3 per cent. Below is an analysis.



MCX-GOLD (₹1,58,466)
For the last three weeks, gold futures (April) has largely been trading flat, within ₹1,58,000 and ₹1,64,000, barring the rise to ₹1,69,880 on March 2.

The breakout of March 2 and a trendline support had kept the bias positive. But the prolonged consolidation is taking the strength out of the bulls.

If gold futures can rebound from ₹1,58,000, it can retain the upward tilt. Otherwise, the bears can take over and the price might drop to ₹1,50,000.

Trade strategy: Retain the buy on gold futures (April) initiated at ₹1,61,634. But revise the target and stop-loss from ₹1,80,000 to ₹1,72,000 and ₹1,54,000 to ₹1,56,000 respectively

ively to account for the loss in bull strength.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,59,435)
Silver futures (May), too, has been in a sideways crawl over the past three weeks. It has been oscillating between ₹2,58,000 and ₹2,82,000, except for a brief rise to ₹2,97,799 on March 2.

In case the support at ₹2,58,000 is breached, it can open the door for a quick decline to ₹2,33,000. The outlook will become positive only if silver futures breaks out of ₹2,82,000.

Trade strategy: Stay out for now. Go short on silver futures if it breaches the support at ₹2,58,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹2,33,000 and ₹2,71,000 respectively.

Oil bulls stay firm

CRUDE CHECK. Traders can buy on dips

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices surged last week too. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$103.10/barrel) was up 11.3 per cent whereas crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹8,943/barrel) gained 11.5 per cent.



BRENT FUTURES (\$103.10)
Brent crude oil futures, after witnessing high volatility, settled the week higher by 11.3 per cent. While there was a drop in price early last week, the contract eventually reclaimed the key \$95 and \$100 levels.

The chart shows that the uptrend is intact. That said, there could be a moderation in price, possibly to \$95-100 support band, before going up further.

Once the uptrend begins, Brent crude futures can see a rise to \$120 in the near term. Note that the \$120-124 price band is a notable resistance.

MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹8,943)
Crude oil futures (April), too, saw considerable volatility in price. On Monday, it rallied to hit

a fresh high of ₹10,177. But then, it lost most of the gains on the same day.

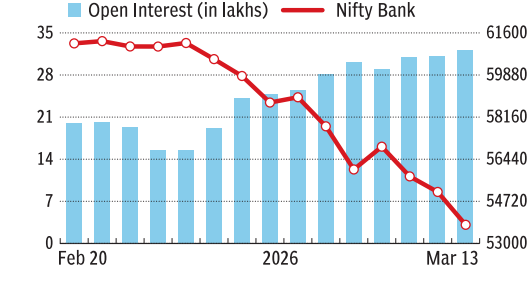
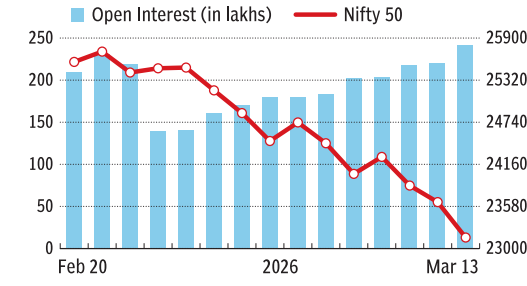
While the fall extended on Tuesday as well, it rebounded from the support at ₹7,300 and continued to rise for the rest of the week.

Going ahead, there might be some correction in price. But the downswing can be arrested by the support at ₹8,500 or ₹8,000.

A resumption in rally can lift the contract to ₹10,300. But if the support at ₹8,000 is breached, the dip can extend to ₹7,000.

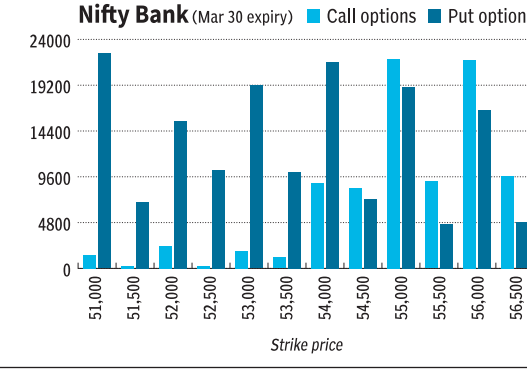
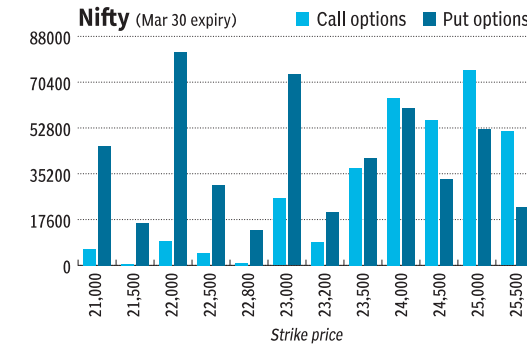
Trade strategy: Go long at ₹8,500 with a stop-loss at ₹7,850. On a rally to ₹9,600, revise the stop-loss to ₹9,200. Book profits at ₹10,300. Risk averse traders can stay out.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain (as on Mar 13)

Put-Call ratio Nifty 1.03 | Nifty Bank 0.75



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Mar 13	Weekly change %	As on Mar 13	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	32283	6	293089	29
Future Index Short	292823	43	136811	20
Net Futures	-260540	49	156278	37
Index Call options Long	695459	17	3340427	13
Index Call options Short	956015	24	2970683	9
Net Call options	-260556	49	369744	49
Index Put options Long	1049392	12	1985818	9
Index Put options Short	593868	22	2534319	3
Net Put Options	455524	1	-548501	-13

FII's have added net short on index futures and increased net short on index calls. They also marginally increased net long on index puts. These factors indicate a bearish bias.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Mar 13)				
AMBER	6,446.00	-18.1	33.4	60.1
PGEL	502.20	-17.6	309.6	56.8
KEI	4,158.00	-15.5	37.7	45.0
FEDERALBNK	263.05	-8.2	1900.6	44.0
COLPAL	1,957.20	-11.2	132.4	43.9
FALL (as on Mar 13)				
WAAREEENER	2,726.60	3.7	81.2	-10.3
POLICYBZR	1,446.00	1.2	117.4	-6.2
HAVELLS	1,310.20	-2.9	137.1	-6.0
UPL	609.40	-3.0	605.6	-5.8
HAL	3,914.40	-2.7	192.6	-4.9

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Mar 16)

SAIL	SAMMAANCAP
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Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI (Weekly change %)	Indication
COMMODITIES (as on Mar 13)				
ALUMINIUM	31-Mar	346.1 (1.8)	2,957 (-30)	Short covering
COPPER	31-Mar	1,187.4 (-0.8)	15,099 (-6)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOIL	20-Apr	8,943.0 (11.5)	10,556 (109)	Long build-up
CRUDEOILM	20-Apr	8,950.0 (11.5)	22,344 (58)	Long build-up
GOLD	2-Apr	1,58,466.0 (-2.0)	7,844 (6)	Short build-up
GOLDGUINEA	31-Mar	1,29,847.0 (-1.9)	14,668 (-4)	Long unwinding
GOLDM	3-Apr	1,58,527.0 (-2.0)	42,600 (4)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	31-Mar	16,291.0 (-2.1)	2,18,436 (7)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	31-Mar	1,59,582.0 (-1.9)	31,023 (3)	Short build-up
LEAD	31-Mar	188.6 (-0.2)	538 (2)	Short build-up
NATURALGAS	26-Mar	291.9 (-1.3)	19,270 (7)	Short build-up
SILVER	5-May	2,59,435.0 (-3.3)	5,889 (-5)	Long unwinding
SILVERM	30-Apr	2,65,668.0 (-3.3)	14,879 (2)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Apr	2,65,897.0 (-3.2)	55,463 (11)	Short build-up
ZINC	31-Mar	324.5 (0.2)	2,858 (-29)	Short covering
CURRENCIES (as on Mar 13)				
USDINR	25-Mar	92.43 (0.6)	29,89,638 (29)	Long build-up
EURINR	25-Mar	106.11 (-0.4)	27,488 (-1)	Long unwinding
GBPINR	25-Mar	122.69 (-0.1)	26,797 (-1)	Long unwinding
JPYINR	25-Mar	58.25 (-0.7)	85 (-1)	Long unwinding

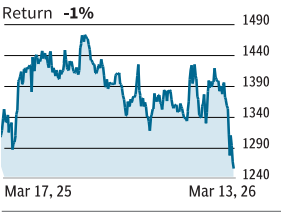
F&O Strategy

Buy ICICI Bank call

KS Badri Narayanan

The stock of ICICI Bank (₹1,254.80) is in an oversold zone and therefore, despite the bearish outlook, we expect it to witness a pullback rally in the short-term. Support levels are ₹1,209 and ₹1,120. Resistances are at ₹1,310 and ₹1,395. A close above ₹1,435 will reconfirm its bullish outlook.

F&O pointers: ICICI Bank March futures closed at ₹1,255.30 against the spot price of ₹1,254.80. Besides, ICICI Bank March futures witnessed accumulation of open positions. But option positioning indicates a possible movement within the ₹1,200-1,400 range and the stock is now near the bot-



tom of this price band.

Strategy: Consider buying 1,270-call option, expecting a short-term relief rally.

The option closed with a premium of ₹20.65 and as the market lot is 700 shares, this would cost ₹14,455. This would be the maximum loss, which would happen if the downtrend extends. Profit potentials are high if ICICI Bank recovers sharply.

Keep the stop loss at ₹15 initially. Shift it to ₹19 if the stock opens on a positive note and stays in the range. Traders can aim for a target of ₹35-40.

Stick to the stop-loss judiciously to protect profit and capital as the market is in high volatile zone. Avoid this trade if ICICI Bank opens below ₹1,240 or above ₹1,270 on Monday.

Follow-up: HAL hit the target.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

Options break-even price

BL Research Bureau

Calculating break-even price in buying and selling a stock or futures contract can be straight forward. But calculating break-even prices while trading options need some calculation. Let us see how to arrive at a breakeven price for vanilla call and put options.

Say, you are bullish on the stock of ITC (₹301.45) and therefore you buy the 305-strike March expiry call option for ₹5. Here, the break-



even price will be the strike-price (305) plus the premium paid (₹5) for buying the option. Hence, your trade will be breakeven at ₹310.

So, if the position is held till expiry and if the stock does not reach ₹310 you will end up in a loss. The opposite is true for the option seller. Though the maximum profit is limited to the premium received, he/she will end up in profit if the stock closes below ₹310 on expiry. However, before expiry, the premium can go up or down from ₹5 depending upon the stock price movement.

Now, let us say that you are bearish on the same stock and so, you buy the 295-strike March expiry put option for ₹4. The breakeven price will be strike-price (295) minus the premium paid (₹4) which is ₹291. Hence, on expiry, you, the put buyer, will profit if the stock price is below ₹291 whereas put seller will profit if the stock price is above ₹291.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The Indian benchmark indices were knocked down badly last week. Nifty 50 and Sensex tumbled over 5 per cent each. Nifty Bank index on the other hand was down about 7 per cent.

We had expected the benchmark indices to bounce back from their key supports. But that view has gone wrong. We now prefer to stay out of the market and just watch what is happening. Charts indicate that there is more room to fall from here.

Among the sectors, the BSE Auto index tumbled about 10 per cent.

FPIS SELL

The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) sold heavily for the second consecutive week. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about \$3.44 billion last week. The FPIs have sold about \$5.7 billion in just two weeks of this month. Continuous selling from the FPIs can keep the Indian benchmark indices under pressure for some more time.

NIFTY 50 (23,151.10)

Short-term view: The outlook is bearish. Resistances are at 23,700 and 23,900. Nifty can fall to 22,800-22,600, the next support zone. Failure to bounce back from this support zone can drag it further lower towards 22,200-22,100.

Nifty will now have to get a strong rise above 24,000 to bring back the bullishness. Only then the upside will open up to revisit 26,000 levels.

Medium-term View: The rally to 28,000 that we were expecting will not happen immediately. For now, the region between 22,200 and 22,000 will be the crucial support to watch next. As seen from the quarterly candles, a bounce from the 22,200-22,000 region can take the Nifty up to 26,000-26,400 again. In that case, the broader sideways range visible on the quarterly candles will continue to remain intact.

Nifty has to rise past 26,400 in order to bring back the targets of 28,000 and 30,000 into play again.

On the other hand, Nifty will come under a big threat if it breaks below 22,000. We will



INDEX OUTLOOK. The break of crucial support last week opens the door for more downside

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Nifty 50 under pressure



LEVELS TO WATCH

- Nifty 50: 22,600, 22,100
- Sensex: 72,700, 72,250
- Nifty Bank: 53,300, 52,200

of seeing 50,000 and even 48,000 on the downside. For now, we place very less probability for this fall to happen.

SENSEX (74,563.92)

Short-term view: The outlook is negative. Resistances are at 75,900 and then in the 77,000-77,500 region. Any intermediate bounce can be capped for now. The Sensex has room on the downside to see 73,000-72,800 in the short term.

The Sensex will now have to rise past 77,500 decisively in order to see some relief. That looks a little difficult under the current circumstances.

Medium-term view: The fall below 75,500 was contrary to our expectation. This has put aside the chances of seeing 90,000 on the upside that we have been mentioning, for now.

However, strong supports are still available at 72,700 and 72,250. A bounce from either of

ded fall to 52,200 instead of 53,500 as was mentioned last week. A strong bounce from around 52,200 will have the potential to take the Nifty Bank index up to 60,000 levels again.

So, for now there is no major disruption to our earlier long-term bullish view. The only change could be in terms of time. The expected rise could now happen with a delay.

As such we retain our view of the Nifty Bank index targeting 64,000-65,000 in the medium term and 68,000-69,000 in the long term.

This view will go wrong if the index declines below 52,000. If that happens, there is a danger

have to wait and watch.

NIFTY BANK (53,757.85)

Short-term view: Immediate support is in the 53,500-53,300 region. A bounce from this support zone can take the index up to 55,500-56,000. But this will just be a corrective bounce. A fresh fall from around 56,000 can break the support at 53,300. Such a break can drag the Nifty Bank index down to 52,200 in the short-term.

A sustained rise above 56,000 is now needed to ease the downside pressure and avoid more fall.

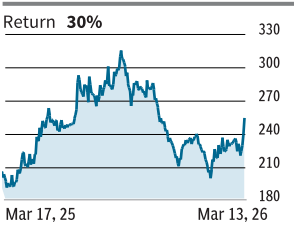
Medium-term view: We may have to allow for an exten-

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU bl. research bureau

ACME Solar Holdings (₹255.60)

Confirms an inverted head and shoulder



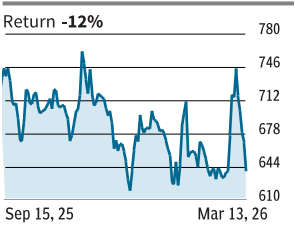
The stock of ACME Solar Holdings was trading in a sideways trend since the beginning of February. That is, it was oscillating between ₹218 and ₹238. Last Friday, the scrip rallied sharply and broke out of ₹238, opening the door for further rally.

Notably, ₹238 is the neckline

of an inverted head and shoulder pattern. So, the confirmation of this chart pattern shows a bullish trend reversal. Although the pattern indicates a rally to ₹280, given the bullish reversal, we expect the upswing to extend to ₹320. Buy now at ₹255 and accumulate at ₹245. Place stop-loss at ₹225. When the price rises to ₹280 and ₹300, revise the stop-loss to ₹255 and ₹280 respectively. Exit at ₹320.

Paras Defence and Space Technologies (₹638.75)

Hovers near a strong base

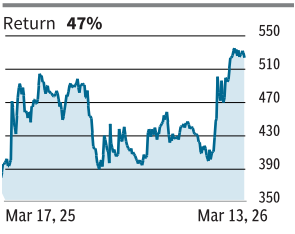


The stock of Paras Defence and Space Technologies has seen higher volatility over the last couple of weeks. Nevertheless, the price stays above the support at ₹620, keeping the broader uptrend valid. Also, the 61.8 per cent Fibonacci retracement of the prior uptrend coincides

at this level. Therefore, there is a chance for the stock to see a rebound. It can break out of ₹770 and rise to ₹930. Go long now at ₹638 and place a stop-loss at ₹580. When the price rises to ₹770, revise the stop-loss to ₹700. After the stop-loss to ₹800 when the stock touches ₹850. Liquidate the longs at ₹900.

Vardhman Textiles (₹536.55)

Retain bullish bias



The stock of Vardhman Textiles has been in an uptrend since the final week of January, when it found support at ₹400. Although the trend has been flat recently, the price action retains the positive bias. So long as the price stays above ₹500, the bias will be bullish.

The price is now hovering near the 21-day moving average, which can help begin the upswing. Once the stock resumes the rally, it can appreciate to ₹700. Buy now at ₹536 and at ₹505. Place initial stop-loss at ₹480. When the stock rises to ₹600, revise the stop-loss higher to ₹560. Tighten the stop-loss to ₹600 when the price hits ₹650. Book profits at ₹700.

TECH QUERY

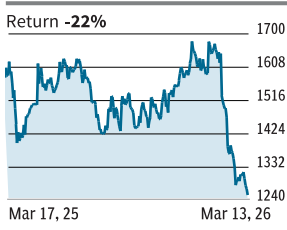


GURUMURTHY K
bl. research bureau

I have bought Infosys shares at ₹1,445. What is the outlook?

Krishna Hegde, Mysuru

Infosys (₹1,248): The outlook is bearish with a double-top reversal pattern on the chart. Resistances are at ₹1,380 and ₹1,450. Infosys share price can fall to ₹1,100. Thereafter a



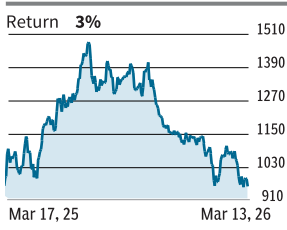
corrective bounce to ₹1,350 is a possibility. This upmove has to take the stock above ₹1,500 to turn the outlook bullish again. But that looks less likely as a rise above ₹1,500 may need some strong positive trigger. So, if the stock turns down again from the

₹1,350-1,450 region, then there is a danger of seeing ₹950-900 on the downside. The chances of going back to your purchase price is very low. So, exit the stock now and accept the loss. From a long-term perspective the ₹950-900 region is a strong support zone. You can consider re-entering the stock around ₹950.

I have shares of UTI Asset Management Company (AMC) bought at ₹915. What is the outlook?

Rohit Mehendarkar

UTI AMC (₹953): Crucial support in the ₹920-₹905 region. A strong bounce from this support zone can be bullish. Looking at the past price movement, the



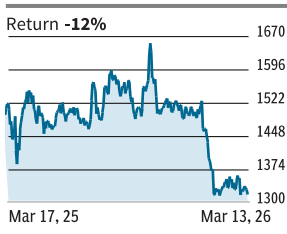
bounce from the ₹920-₹905 region may have the potential to take the price higher to ₹1,400-₹1,500 over the medium term. But a break below ₹905 can drag the stock down to ₹850. If you have high-risk appetite, keep a stop-loss at ₹890

and hold the stock. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,110 when the price goes up to ₹1,210. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹1,240 and ₹1,320 when the price touches ₹1,330 and ₹1,390 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹1,450. If you don't want to take the risk, then exit at current levels itself.

I have purchased Cipla at ₹1,510. What is the outlook for this stock?

V Natarajan

Cipla (₹1,314): The stock is stuck in a narrow range of ₹1,280-1,380 for more than a month. The region around ₹1,290 is a very crucial support. A decisive break



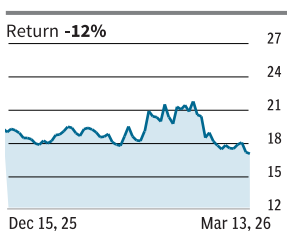
below it will confirm a bearish double-top pattern. That in turn can drag the price down to ₹1,000-980. That will also be bearish from a long-term perspective. It will keep the downside open to see ₹700. To avoid this fall the stock has to sustain above ₹1,290 and

breach ₹1,400. Only then the upside will open up for ₹1,600 again. Key resistance to watch is at ₹1,685. A strong break above it is needed to regain the bullish momentum. If that happens, the stock can rally to ₹2,600-2,700 over the long term. Exit the stock now.

I have shares of A B Infrabuild. My purchase price is ₹20.40. What is the outlook?

Sri Guru Ganesh, Bengaluru

A B Infrabuild (₹16.90): The stock has very limited data available to do a detailed technical analysis. The recent price action indicates that the stock is struggling to breach ₹19. The 21-Day Moving Average (DMA) is on



the verge of making a bearish cross below the 55- and 100-DMA. Both these factors leave the bias negative. Immediate support is at ₹16.70. A break below it can trigger a fresh fall to ₹14.70 or even ₹12.70. To avoid this fall the stock has to sustain above ₹16.70 and rise

above ₹19. Only then a rise to ₹23 will come into the picture. But such a rise looks less probable as seen from the price action on the chart. So, exit the stock and accept the loss.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

- Aurobindo Pharma**
- Premier Energies**
- ABB India**
- Ipca Laboratories**
- Thermax**

Last week's prize winner
Kashinath Nayak

Last week's winning stock
Kirloskar Oil Engines

Closing price (Mar 6)
₹1,513.55

Closing price (Mar 13)
₹1,452.35

Return:
-4 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50, declined 5.5 and 5.3 per cent respectively last week. BSE Power and BSE Healthcare were the top performers, delivering 0.7 per cent and -1.8 per cent, respectively. BSE Auto and BSE Bankex were the worst performers, falling 9.9 per cent and 7 per cent, respectively.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Reality	Tech
P/E	20.3	20.5	31.2	14.3	51.0	58.2	32.9	37.9	21.4	19.6	8.9	32.6	11.5	34.7	24.9
P/BV	3.2	4.0	6.0	2.1	13.4	15.0	7.3	6.5	5.9	3.4	1.6	4.2	2.3	4.4	7.4
Dividend Yield	1.4	1.2	1.3	2.1	0.5	0.5	1.6	0.6	2.9	1.2	2.7	1.4	2.4	0.4	2.2
Weekly Return (%)	-5.3 ▼	-5.5 ▼	-9.9 ▼	-7.0 ▼	-4.2 ▼	-4.1 ▼	-3.9 ▼	-1.8 ▼	-3.7 ▼	-5.9 ▼	-4.6 ▼	0.7 ▲	-4.4 ▼	-4.3 ▼	-4.0 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	-10.7 ▼	-11.5 ▼	-13.9 ▼	-11.1 ▼	-2.0 ▼	-7.1 ▼	-8.3 ▼	0.4 ▲	-18.4 ▼	-7.5 ▼	-8.5 ▼	1.1 ▲	-5.0 ▼	-16.5 ▼	-15.8 ▼
Annual Return (%)	3.4 ▲	1.0 ▲	16.5 ▲	9.3 ▲	17.1 ▲	4.0 ▲	-6.6 ▼	8.9 ▲	-20.5 ▼	25.3 ▲	13.6 ▲	12.6 ▲	24.2 ▲	-11.3 ▼	-11.9 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
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360 One [1]	10275.29	35.4	4.5	202512	51.5	18.4	22.1	10.0	-3.5	14.3	2.0	1273.0	766.1	
3M India [1]	32997.1	542.7	60.8	17.3	202406	-0.5	21.6	3.0	23.3	-3.8	39.8	0.0	3830.0	2680.1
A B B [2]	6394.6	78.8	81.2	17.3	202512	5.1	-18.3	27.4	39.4	5.4	9.8	0.1	6555.0	4590.1
A B Real Estate [1]	1138.6	-19.0		3.4	202512	-59.8	-389.2	-52.3	-317.9	-7.5	-0.2	1.0	2535.0	1125.1
Aadhar Hsg. Fin.	460.4	24.0	19.2	2.9	202512	18.8	-22.7	18.7	20.0	1.2	11.4	2.8	547.8	399.0
Aarti Industries [5]	420.0	10.2	41.1	2.7	202512	25.8	221.3	13.3	1.6	0.4	6.2	0.7	494.0	338.2
AASVS Financials [2]	1168.6	62.0	18.9	2.5	204043	21.3	12.3	25.4	14.2	-4.8	9.9	3.2	2238.4	1541.5
Abbott India	2691.1	717.3	37.5	14.3	202512	6.8	4.2	9.3	14.2	-1.6	5.0	0.0	5392.1	3260.0
ACC	1379.4	134.0	10.3	1.3	202512	8.6	-65.4	16.4	4.7	-8.1	17.9	0.0	2123.3	1369.7
ACCME Solar Hold. [2]	255.6	8.3	30.9	3.2	202512	42.3	-3.7	61.7	319.0	12.0	7.4	2.8	324.3	172.9
Action Const.Eng. [2]	840.5	35.5	23.7	5.6	202512	41.7	24.9	26.3	18.9	-7.7	14.0	0.9	1584.0	1041.1
Adani Energy Sol.	991.3	18.7	53.0	5.1	202512	15.4	-1.7	20.0	4.8	-0.1	10.1	2.2	1067.3	745.5
Adani Enterp. Sol.	1960.3	28.7	68.2	4.2	202512	8.6	1823.5	-5.1	-15.4	-3.9	9.0	1.8	2612.8	1850.0
Adani Green	860.8	10.4	83.1	7.3	202512	7.6	106.8	14.8	10.1	0.2	9.4	6.4	1179.2	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1363.6	54.8	24.9	3.7	202512	21.9	24.9	26.3	18.9	-7.7	14.0	0.9	1584.0	1041.1
Adani Power [2]	146.7	5.9	24.7	4.8	202512	-8.9	-18.9	-1.9	-12.2	5.6	9.2	0.7	18.2	9.4
Adani Total Gas [1]	563.9	5.8	96.6	13.8	202512	16.4	11.4	17.7	-3.9	16.9	17.4	0.4	79.4	453.5
Aditya AMC [5]	934.7	35.3	26.5	7.6	202512	7.4	21.0	12.0	11.8	1.1	35.5	0.0	1044.4	562.5
Aditya Bkr. Fas. [1]	393.3	6.2		1.2	202512	9.9	-215.9	8.7	4.5	-5.1	0.0	1.3	107.7	9.1
Aditya Birla Cap.	310.5	1.3	22.9	2.5	202512	27.4	40.5	13.0	-3.2	-4.9	9.4	4.4	369.3	160.4
Aegis Logistics [1]	602.3	21.9	27.5	3.6	202512	1.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	9.4	14.5	0.9	946.5	598.0
Aether Industries.	1000.3	16.9	59.3	5.7	202512	44.4	46.2	52.7	93.2	-1.1	9.7	0.1	1085.5	723.2
Affcons Infrastr.	278.9	13.9	20.1	1.9	202512	-7.3	5.7	-3.1	-1.9	-1.4	14.4	0.6	496.9	271.7
AIA [138.5]	12.1	42.9	1.2	202512	17.2	-1.9	-3.1	-2.2	-5.9	11.5	0.1	1687.2	949.5	
AIA Engineering [2]	3664.1	124.8	29.4	4.6	202512	-0.1	14.6	-2.6	10.3	-0.3	19.1	0.1	4200.0	3000.6
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3028.9	81.2	37.3	8.8	202512	20.0	17.6	14.8	13.0	1.3	12.0	0.0	3158.2	2212.1
Ako Nobel	2870.6	83.0	34.6	5.8	202512	-13.6	-12.5	-7.0	-12.1	3.7	39.1	0.1	3909.3	2649.1
Alkem Pharma [2]	3337.3	44.1	68.9	3.1	202512	10.8	21.0	18.3	29.4	-4.0	14.2	0.2	1101.6	611.0
Alkem Lab [2]	5351.5	20.9	26.6	4.8	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	11.0	-3.4	20.0	0.1	5933.0	4627.9
Alkyl Amines [2]	1276.9	35.3	36.1	4.5	202512	-4.6	-3.4	-0.5	1.2	-0.7	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1251.5
Allied Blenders [2]	441.7	9.6	46.1	7.9	202512	3.0	19.5	14.0	135.6	-6.9	21.0	0.9	720.0	278.9
Ally Industries [1]	131.1	1.5												
Amara Raja Ener.	774.1	37.4	20.7	1.8	202512	4.2	-27.7	-12.8	21.6	-3.3	0.0	0.0	1108.7	769.2
Amber Enterp.	6451.2	66.0	97.7	6.2	202512	37.9	26.4	30.7	4.6	-18.0	13.5	0.8	8625.0	5404.0
Ambuja Cements [2]	425.6	15.7	27.2	1.9	202512	9.2	89.9	16.4	-8.7	-8.8	12.7	0.0	625.0	424.5
Anand Pathi Wea.	3037.3	44.1	68.9	3.1	202512	10.8	21.0	18.3	29.4	-4.0	14.2	0.2	1101.6	611.0
Anant Raj [2]	449.9	14.6	30.7	2.9	202512	20.0	30.8	22.6	36.8	-0.0	10.9	0.1	744.1	366.2
Angel One [1]	216.2	8.5	25.5	3.4	202512	5.8	-4.6	-14.6	-42.5	-1.6	25.8	0.7	328.3	194.2
Apur Inds.	8972.7	246.9	36.3	7.4	202512	16.3	29.8	20.8	22.8	-13.7	32.6	0.1	11641.8	4270.0
APOLCO Tubes [2]	133.5	21.1	42.9	1.6	202512	17.2	42.9	-3.2	-2.2	-2.5	11.5	0.1	238.6	132.4
Apollo Hospitals [5]	7549.9	126.3	59.8	12.0	202512	17.2	38.8	14.5	38.6	-2.2	17.5	0.6	8099.0	6018.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	400.4	23.0	17.4	1.6	202512	11.8	43.4	6.2	8.3	-9.0	10.9	0.3	540.3	368.0
Aptus Value Hou.	222.1	17.8	12.5	2.4	202512	23.0	24.0	28.1	25.5	-2.7	15.1	1.5	364.9	218.0
Asahi India Glas [1]	829.8	12.3	67.5	5.7	202512	4.8	32.8	5.3	-4.7	0.1	31.1	0.9	1073.0	576.6
Ashok Leyland [1]	731.7	18.7	39.1	2.4	202512	23.6	17.3	30.3	-12.3	14.3	30.3	-12.3	14.3	30.3
Asian Paints [1]	2196.2	42.6	51.6	10.8	202512	3.9	5.7	1.3	-6.4	-3.7	24.4	0.1	2385.5	2163.0
Aster DM Health.	667.7	7.0	95.2	8.3	202512	12.9	10.1	8.5	38.5	-0.8	11.6	0.5	720.0	419.5
Astral [1]	161.11	19.2	84.0	11.5	202512	10.3	5.6	6.7	-2.1	-4.6	20.8	0.1	1768.0	1232.0
Astrazeneca Phar.	6389.9	83.2	100.8	12.3	202512	38.9	-42.3	34.5	24.1	-4.0	32.9	0.1	10550.1	6501.6
Ather Energy [1]	705.8	-16.9		9.9	202512	50.2	-140.2	50.9	25.0	5.0	0.0	1.1	790.0	287.3
Atul	6461.2	201.8	32.0	3.2	202512	11.1	47.8	13.3	42.9	0.6	12.8	0.0	7193.0	4882.0
AU Small Finance	884.2	30.9	28.6	3.6	202512	14.9	26.3	22.3	13.6	-8.3	0.0	0.0	1038.8	479.0
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	310.2	14.8	21.4	1.4	202512	18.0	21.9	21.9	21.9	21.9	21.9	21.9	21.9	21.9
Authum Invest [1]	477.9	42.8	11.2	2.5	202512	-22.5	-70.2	-16.0	-9.5	10.6	29.7	0.1	683.5	271.2
Avanti [2]	384.1	4.0	87.1	10.9	202512	13.3	18.3	15.4	5.3	-1.1	18.0	0.1	4916.3	3528.7
AWL Agra Busine. [1]	1179.3	7.4	23.4	2.3	202512	10.5	-30.0	21.8	-19.5	-2.5	19.8	0.3	291.3	172.1
Axis Bank [2]	1197.3	84.5	14.2	1.8	202512	4.8	4.0	4.5	-6.8	-9.0	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1005.0

B H E L [2]	258.5	2.3	110.5	3.7	202512	16.4	189.8	10.4	56.9	-0.2	3.2	0.4	305.9	192.9	
B PCL [1]	391.1	31.9	57.6	7.5	1.5	202512	5.2	90.0	0.5	78.3	-9.5	28.1	0.7	39.19	2588.4
Bajaj Auto [1]	8879.9	319.9	27.8	7.3	202512	21.2	27.8	14.8	18.7	-9.5	15.7	0.2	10186.6	7088.3	
Bajaj Finance [1]	8591.1	29.3	29.2	5.2	202512	18.4	-2.1	20.7	14.0	-10.0	11.4	3.8	11025.5	810.2	
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1738.6	62.1	28.0	3.6	202512	24.9	11.6	15.6	15.9	-7.0	12.4	4.9	2194.7	1766.1	
Bajaj Holdings [2]	9506.0	660.2	14.4	1.6	202512	127.6	15.3	-34.1	-2.2	-9.9	11.5	0.0	14873.2	9495.0	
Bajaj Housing [2]	82.1	3.0	27.5	3.2	202512	18.2	23.2	18.9	27.1	-2.4	9.5	4.7	137.0	81.4	
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2224.8	67.9	32.8	4.1	202512	6.9	-15.0	2.6	-26.0	-1.3	11.9	0.3	2815.4	2020.0	
Balarampur Chini [1]	448.8	22.2	21.9	2.5	202512	22.0	61.0	15.4	9.0	1.0	11.1	0.6	72.0	393.4	
Bandhan Bank [1]	175.6	6.3	28.1	1.2	202512	0.9	-51.8	0.0	59.4	-4.0	0.0	0.0	12.5	134.3	
Bank of Baroda [2]	281.1	3.7	75.5	0.9	202512	3.2	4.4	4.7	-4.8	0.0	0.0	325.6	202.2		
Bank of India [1]	150.1	22.4	6.7	0.9	202512	4.0	6.7	7.9	19.7	-6.0	0.0	0.0	178.5	93.8	
Bank of Maha [2]	64.1	8.4	7.6	1.6	202512	16.1	27.4	19.3	22.9	-8.6	0.0	0.0	77.0	38.1	
BASF India [1]	3449.6	84.3	40.9	3.9	202512	6.3	0.9	-19.9	-39.7	0.3	17.9	0.1	5418.2	2969.0	
Bata India [5]	699.1	14.9	46.8	3.8	202512	8.8	9.0	23.2	16.8	-0.6	14.9	0.0	1300.1	696.9	
Bayer Crop Sci. [1]	4511.7	149.2	30.2	6.5	202512	4.6	179.8	7.7	28.7	-2.0	23.8	0.0	6540.0	4276.9	
BEML Ltd. [5]	1526.0	29.9	51.0	4.5	202512	23.7	-191.7	8.4	-4.8	-7.7	11.7	0.1	2437.4	1230.4	
Berger Paints [1]	408.0	8.6	42.5	7.6	202512	0.3	5.1	5.1	-1.7	-7.8	24.8	0.1	604.6	409.4	
Bharat Dynamics [1]	1311.4	15.8	92.9	11.4	202512	-31.4	-50.4	57.2	2.5	-3.3	10.2	0.0	2099.6	1068.0	
Bharat Electronics [1]	49.6	1.2	12.4	1.1		202512	1.1	14.5	1.9	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	
Bharat Forge [2]	1675.6	24.4	68.5	8.6	202512	25.0	41.3	4.5	18.2	-12.9	11.7	0.9	1939.9	919.1	
Bharti Airtel [1]	1803.6	53.8	33.5	8.7	202512	19.6	-12.1	25.0	58.1	3.6	14.3	2.2	2147.4	1620.9	
Bharti Hexacom [5]	147.6	35.2	41.9	11.8	202512	4.8	13.6	67.8	-8.0	16.5	15.0	201.0	1225.0	125.0	
Biocon [1]	603.6	10.0	60.6	6.3	202512	11.2	117.6	13.9	-8.3	-18.4	1.8	0.0	1025.0	595.0	
Blooom [1]	383.2	5.1	75.8	1.6	202512	9.3	173.6	14.4	5.9	1.0	0.0	0.0	425.0	253.5	
Birla Corp. [1]	781.4	74.2	10.5	1.0	202512	-4.3	141.6	6.4	151.7	-9.7	7.2	0.6	1537.2	780.0	
Birlasoft Ltd [2]	261.8	17.5	20.7	2.7	202512	-1.1	22.7	-2.6	-15.1	-2.8	20.8	0.0	43.38	320.2	
Blue Bird Int'l [1]	261.2	15.6	15.8	1.2	202512	-33.6	-34.8	47.8	41.9	-3.5	39.0	0.1	428.3	240.3	
Blue Bird Express [2]	527.74	1.2	22.9	4.2	202512	6.8	16.9	16.9	16.9	16.9	16.9	16.9	16.9	16.9	
Blue Jet Health [2]	358.8	16.9	21.2	5.0	202512	-39.6	59.4	20.6	25.1	-7.0	4.0	0.0	102.82	5196.0	
Blue Star [2]	1832.6	26.0	10.5	12.1	202512	4.2	9.4	9.5	-2.6	-9.5	25.8	0.1	2266.7	1521.2	
Bosch [1]	20195.8	763.8	38.5	6.4	202512	9.4	19.9	11.3	14.2	-9.5	20.5	0.0	0.04884	32593.8	
Brainerd [1]	224.3	3.0	22.3	1.0	202512	17.2	12.4	12.4	12.4	12.4	12.4	12.4	12.4	12.4	
Brigade Enterprise [1]	653.3	31.1	21.0	2.5	202512	7.6	11.7	1.0	17.8	-1.9	13.3	1.2	1332.4	658.1	
Britannia Inds [1]	5808.5	100.3	37.9	37.5	202512	9.5	16.9	8.0	11.0	-3.0	5.9	0.0	3337.0	4324.5	

Claiming refund for e-banking fraud

BANK-WISE. A lowdown on RBI’s new norms on limiting customer liability in electronic banking transactions

bl.explainer

Kumar Shankar Roy
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As digital payments evolve and fraud risks change, the RBI wants customer protection rules to keep pace. On March 6, the RBI issued draft directions reviewing its 2017 framework on limiting customer liability in unauthorised electronic banking transactions. Here is a lowdown.

What is the extent to which customers can be compensated for small-value fraudulent electronic banking transactions?

Under the draft framework, a *bona fide* individual victim can get compensation for fraudulent electronic banking transactions involving a gross loss of up to ₹50,000. The compensation is capped at 85 per cent of the net loss, or ₹25,000, whichever is lower. Net loss means the loss after reducing any recovery already made, whether before or after compensation is paid. This compensation can be claimed only once in a lifetime. In a joint account, only one account holder can claim it, and that person cannot later claim it again in an individual capacity.

But this is not an automatic payout in every fraud case. The bank must first be satisfied that the claim is *bona fide* under its internal policy. The customer must also report the transaction on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal or Helpline 1930, and to the bank, within five calendar days of the transaction.

Which are the electronic banking transactions covered by the rules?

The draft directions widen the scope of the framework beyond unauthorised transactions. They now cover “fraudulent electronic banking transactions”, which include both certain authorised transactions tainted by fraud and unauthorised transactions. In other words, the rules are no longer confined only to unauthorised electronic banking transactions. An authorised electronic banking transaction includes one done by the customer, or by a previously authorised third party, using a standing instruction, mandate, OTP, password, card details or another bank-provided electronic authentication method. But the draft also says some fraud-hit authorised transactions will still fall within the protection framework. These include cases where a third party uses credentials obtained from the customer through fraud, where the customer approves a transaction under coercion or duress, and where the customer is tricked into sending money



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to a scammer posing as a legitimate recipient. The draft also links “electronic banking transaction” to the Payment and Settlement Systems Act definition of electronic funds transfer, and specifically includes both card-not-present and card-present transactions. It also envisages reporting and review across categories such as card present, card not present, Internet banking, mobile banking and ATM transactions.

What facilities should banks provide for reporting of fraudulent electronic banking transactions?

Banks must provide customers with 24x7 access through multiple reporting channels. These can include phone banking, SMS, email, IVR, a dedicated toll-free helpline and reporting through the home branch. These facilities are meant both for reporting fraudulent electronic banking transactions and for reporting loss or theft of a payment instrument such as a card. The bank must also build an alert system. The transaction alert SMS must carry a number to which the customer can immediately send an objection SMS. The bank must also place a direct reporting link on its website home page.

The draft also requires a clear audit trail. The communication system used for alerts and customer responses must record the date and time when the alert was delivered and when the customer’s response was received.

When is a customer entitled to zero liability and reversal of transaction? What are the timelines prescribed?

The draft gives a customer zero liability in two broad situations: First, if the fraudulent electronic banking transaction happened because of negligence or deficiency on part of the bank, the cus-

tomers get zero liability and reversal, regardless of whether it was reported by the customer. Second, in cases of third-party breach, the customer gets zero liability and reversal if the unauthorised fraudulent electronic banking transaction is reported to the bank within five calendar days of the transaction.

Where reversal is required, the bank must reverse the transaction with value dating from the original transaction date. That means the customer should not lose interest or bear any extra interest or charges because of the delay in reversal.

The bank must examine the complaint, establish liability and issue its response within the timeline in its policy, but in any case not later than 30 calendar days from receipt of the complaint. If the case qualifies for zero liability, the response must include details of reversal. Also, once the customer has reported the fraudulent transaction, any further unauthorised transaction after that point must be borne by the bank.

What is third-party breach under these rules?

The draft defines third-party breach as a situation where the deficiency lies neither with the bank nor with the customer, but elsewhere in the system. The directions also spell out who this “elsewhere in the system” could be. This includes intermediaries such as a third-party application provider, payment aggregator, payment gateway and telecom service provider. So, if the failure arose at one of these layers rather than within the bank or because of customer negligence, the case may fall within the third-party breach category. Why does this matter in practice? Because if a third-party breach leads to an unauthorised fraudulent electronic banking transaction and the customer reports it within five calendar days, the customer gets zero liability and

reversal. If it is reported after five calendar days, the customer may still get compensation in eligible cases under the small-value compensation mechanism, subject to the stated conditions.

How is the compensation shared between the RBI, customer’s bank and beneficiary bank?

The draft lays down a fixed sharing formula for the proposed small-value compensation mechanism, with the exact contributions specified separately for the two loss bands. For losses below ₹29,412, compensation works out to 85 per cent of net loss. Of the gross loss amount, 65 per cent is to be borne by the RBI, 10 per cent by the customer’s bank and 10 per cent by the beneficiary bank. Where the loss amount is ₹29,412 or more but not more than ₹50,000, the compensation is capped at ₹25,000. In that case, the contribution is fixed at ₹19,118 from the RBI, ₹2,941 from the customer’s bank and ₹2,941 from the beneficiary bank. The bank must pay the customer within five calendar days of receiving the compensation application and then seek reimbursement from the RBI on a quarterly basis. The RBI’s press release adds that this arrangement is proposed only for one year initially and may later be reviewed with the aim of increasing banks’ share and reducing or eliminating the RBI’s share.

How does lost amount recovery affect compensation?

The draft makes it clear that compensation is based on net loss, not just the amount first reported as lost. So, if some money is recovered before compensation is paid, the customer’s loss comes down and compensation is calculated on that reduced amount. If money is recovered after compensation has already been paid, the customer’s bank must recalculate compensation based on the revised net loss and apportion the recovered amount accordingly. For example, if a customer reports a fraudulent loss of ₹40,000 and ₹15,000 is recovered before compensation is paid, the net loss becomes ₹25,000. Compensation then works out to 85 per cent of net loss, or ₹21,250. RBI’s illustration says the Reserve Bank would bear ₹16,250, while the customer’s bank and the beneficiary bank would bear ₹2,500 each.

If compensation of ₹25,000 has already been paid on a ₹40,000 loss and recovery happens later, the bank must recalculate the payout on the revised net loss and redistribute the recovered amount among the customer, the RBI, the customer’s bank and the beneficiary bank in the manner set out in the draft illustrations.

bl.interview

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
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Health insurance is only as good as the claims it pays. Siddharth Singhal, Business Head, Health Insurance at Policybazaar.com, explains to *bl.portfolio* the basics so as to avoid claim rejections and flags the most common sticking points that delay or derail claims.

Edited excerpts:

What are the basic parameters that help to avoid claim rejection?

First and foremost, it is always recommended to disclose current and past medical history of all the members involved in the policy. If you have diabetes, hypertension, heart conditions, or had any surgeries, or any sort of fractures in the past, or some other serious ailments, these should be disclosed. One must also disclose any lifestyle habits such as smoking or alcohol consumption. Second, one must understand waiting periods. There are three types of waiting periods. One is the initial waiting period of 30 days, during which only accident related claims will be accepted. Then, there are slowly advancing illnesses’ waiting period, which includes cataract, hernia, knee replacement, and other ailments that have a two-year waiting period. Then, there is a 3-year waiting period for any illness which existed at the time of buying the policy, called pre-existing illness/disease (PED).

Waiting periods and full disclosure are the two basic conditions, once met, should significantly lower the chances of claim rejection.

There could be cases where one forgets a doctor consultation three years ago or is unaware of a condition. How far back one must go for disclosure of medical conditions? Chronic illness and hospitalisations must be declared. But if somebody is actively unaware of a condition, obviously, that is



‘5 years on, claim can’t be rejected unless it’s fraud’

POLICY-WISE. On disclosures, waiting periods, sub-limits and smoother claim settlement

something a person cannot disclose.

Regarding doctor consultations, if it is a regular feature, for instance, GERD (gastro-oesophageal reflux disease), or you had to be treated in a hospital, then we should declare it.

Sub-limits on coverage for cataracts, maternity or knee replacement seem to be a problem faced by policyholders often. Where can one find complete information on sub-limits within a policy?

Some of the earlier plans had a lot of sub-limits including room rents (₹5,000 per day). These plans would have proportionate deduction from the claim and not just room rent. Most of the plans now offer a single private AC room, which should be preferred.

The second type of sub-limit is treatment-specific which caps the claim amount on cataracts at ₹50,000 per eye or knee replacement at ₹1-2 lakh. But now most of the new-age plans have done away with those limits as they create friction at the time of claim. Now, in fact, you would see a lot of knee replacement bills as high as ₹8-9 lakh which are again paid to the customer. So, I think it is better to assess your policy and upgrade to a better plan, which does not have any such sort of sub-limit. One

● PROFILE

Siddharth Singhal is Business Head, Health Insurance at Policybazaar.com

can find information on sub-limits in the policy copy or the digital copy where you can search for sub-limits, or you can find it in customer information sheet, where crucial information pertaining to policy is provided, which must be reviewed.

The other point of friction is when the insurer rejects a claim on medical basis such as ‘hospitalisation not necessary’ or ‘treatment method is not compliant’. How to resolve such issues?

Obviously, the revenue model for hospitals is different from insurance. So, I think here the role of broker, the intermediary and a player like Policybazaar comes into picture which can take an independent stand whether required or not and such cases can certainly be contested. When purchasing a policy it is important to buy from an institution that has claims experience.

Also, if you are going for hospitalisation, its always important to inform your insurance

company first. In case of an emergency as well, one should inform the insurance company within 24 hours of hospitalisation. In case of a divergence in medical opinion at the time of the claim, there are redressal mechanisms such as producing more evidence from the treating doctor, raising the issue to the grievance officer or ombudsman. Then, there is the court of law where issues should be resolved. Most cases get resolved at the lower levels.

With claim handling in mind, there is a view that an agent-assisted policy purchase can be beneficial at the time of claims handling. As an online business, how would you counter that?

I would say that it is a slightly oldish perception and that is also changing very fast. India is a huge market for sure, and obviously, agents are also doing their part in propagating insurance. But as a large company, we work with all insurance firms and have developed claims expertise. Roughly, we have about 600-odd people in the in-house claims team which looks at customer claims, what are the procedures of claims, where it could get stuck, documentations required, and so on. Wherever required, we fight with the insurance companies. So, I think that

is where online space becomes important.

Claims made after the moratorium period of five years cannot be rejected? Are there any obstacles even after moratorium period?

Yes, moratorium period is a great initiative. After five years, your claim cannot be rejected unless it is proven to be fraudulent. Otherwise, after five years, the claim cannot be rejected.

Policyholders who ported their policies often complain that even after completing or serving a part of the PED waiting period, claims are being rejected. What could be the reason?

There is a confusion which happens at the time of porting, regarding disclosure. This is because sometimes a customer may feel they had declared this condition to the previous company, so they don’t need to declare it again to the new company. But, it is always important to declare any new medical condition or any past medical condition at the time of porting. So, if you’ve already, let’s say, served three years in your previous policy, then those three years will get carried forward. However, this will apply only to the original sum insured. If a higher sum is opted for in the new policy, then the waiting period will apply to the difference.

Is there any other point you would like to highlight for safe claims process?

As mentioned, understand the waiting periods, make the right disclosures and buy from a solid intermediary. Also, adding a few riders would improve the claims experience. Day one covers reduced waiting periods for diabetes, high blood pressure, or other ailments from three years to 30 days. Consumables cover is also important as close to 8-10 per cent of the hospital bill for kits, gloves and such are not covered without the rider. Look for plans that have a very few or no sub-limits for any disease. These should significantly improve claims experience.

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.6	6.4	6.4	Nov 14
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5.25	Jan 07
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.3	6.25	Mar 02
Canara Bank	5.5	6.5	6.25	6.25	Jan 05
Central Bank of India	5	6.2	6.25	6	Dec 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.6	6.15	6.05	Mar 03
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	Dec 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	Feb 24
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.75	6	5.95	Feb 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	6.3	6.45	6.1	6	Dec 11
Union Bank	6.1	6.6	6.25	6	Feb 11
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	Mar 13
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7.25	7.25	7	Mar 06
CSB Bank	6.75	7	6.5	5.75	Sep 10
City Union Bank	6.25	7	6.5	6.25	Mar 11
DCB Bank	6.5	7	7	7.15	Jan 16
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	6.95	6.25	7	Mar 01
Federal Bank	6	6.7	6.75	6.4	Mar 12
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Mar 13
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	5.5	7.2	7.2	7.2	Mar 04
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	6.9	6.65	Sep 25
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.25	6.65	Feb 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	6.65	6.15	6.15	Aug 01
Kotak Bank	6	6.7	6.7	6.4	Feb 11
Karur Vysya Bank	6.65	6.55	6.55	6.55	Sep 26
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.7	6.2	6.2	Mar 10
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.4	7.1	6.6	6.6	Jan 08
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	7	Mar 05
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	6.9	7.4	7	Mar 02
ESAF Small Finance Bank	4.75	8	7.25	6	Mar 01
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.25	7.5	7.77	Jan 10
Suryodaya Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	7.25	7.9	06-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	7.5	7.5	7.25	Dec 01
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.45	7.25	7.2	05-Aug

Data as on respective banks' website on 13 Mar 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; Interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

ALERTS.

Shri Health Suraksha 2.0

Shriram General Insurance has launched Shri Health Suraksha 2.0, a new health insurance plan with wider cover and more flexibility for customers. It removes limits on room rent and ICU charges, so patients can choose hospital facilities based on treatment needs. The plan also offers unlimited restoration of the sum insured if it is fully used during the policy year.

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

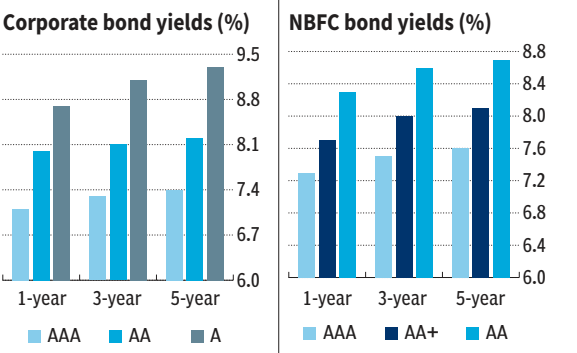
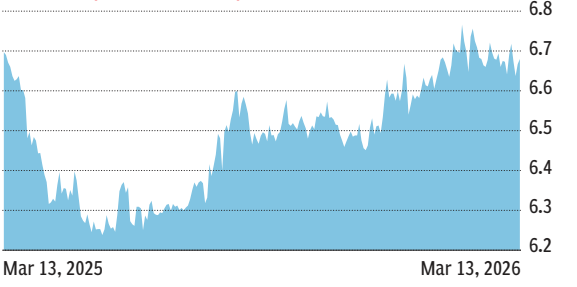
Small Savings Scheme		Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
		Oct 1 - Dec 31, 2025	Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit		4.0	4.0	Annually
Post Office Time Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5 [#]	7.5 [#]	Annually
Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on Dec 31, 2025
#Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India

Bond yields

10-year benchmark G-Sec yield (%)

Latest **6.68** | Month-ago **6.68** | Year-ago **6.70**



Yields on government securities of different maturities (%)



Source: Bloomberg (FIMMDA data), RBI Note: All data as on Mar 13, 2026 or latest available



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	57.7	17104	1.7	0.5	2.8	12.9	10.0	13.8	0.40
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	103.4	77452	1.4	0.9	6.0	15.8	13.4	14.6	0.55
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	84.9	51404	1.5	0.7	7.2	16.7	15.2	14.9	0.60
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1063.5	40085	1.6	1.0	3.8	13.3	12.2	13.7	0.49
*****	JM Large Cap	142.4	443	2.4	0.9	4.8	13.1	11.1	11.1	0.40
*****	Kotak Large Cap	535.1	10925	1.7	0.6	6.1	13.4	10.8	12.9	0.42
*****	SBI Large Cap	86.9	55246	1.5	0.8	5.4	12.5	10.3	12.4	0.41
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	482.8	30094	1.6	1.0	3.9	13.1	10.9	12.3	0.43
***	Bandhan Large Cap	71.9	2024	2.0	0.9	6.9	15.2	11.2	12.7	0.40
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	206.0	2639	2.0	0.8	4.4	14.1	11.2	12.8	0.42
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	78.4	1477	2.1	0.6	4.8	12.9	10.8	13.0	0.41
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	954.2	7580	1.9	1.1	6.0	12.9	9.2	11.2	0.34
***	Invesco India Largecap	63.4	1702	2.0	0.7	5.8	15.0	11.7	12.6	0.41
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	104.0	40184	1.5	0.5	4.9	11.1	9.2	13.3	0.36
***	Tata Large Cap	469.8	2784	2.0	1.0	4.7	12.9	10.8	12.0	0.42
***	UTI Large Cap	248.7	12658	1.8	0.9	1.7	10.5	8.7	11.7	0.32
**	DSP Large Cap	439.9	7270	1.8	0.9	3.1	15.7	11.4	12.1	0.46
**	HSBC Large Cap	447.0	1894	2.1	1.3	6.8	13.5	9.8	12.6	0.34
**	LIC MF Large Cap	50.4	1422	2.2	1.1	2.5	9.9	7.8	10.6	0.28
**	Union Largecap	21.8	453	2.5	1.7	3.5	11.3	9.2	-	0.33
**	Axis Large Cap	55.9	32437	1.6	0.7	2.5	10.9	7.1	12.2	0.23
*	Groww Largecap	40.1	132	2.5	1.3	7.1	12.4	9.4	11.5	0.33
*	PGIM India Large Cap	309.7	568	2.4	0.9	2.9	9.0	7.4	10.2	0.26
-	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.3	737	2.3	0.8	3.9	12.4	9.9	-	0.37
-	Taurus Large Cap	149.8	51	2.6	2.3	7.3	15.4	10.9	10.6	0.34

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	127.6	14780	1.7	0.5	11.0	21.6	17.1	16.0	0.60
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	313.9	28580	1.6	0.8	7.7	17.8	15.8	15.0	0.59
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	954.5	28506	1.6	0.8	8.6	19.1	17.8	16.0	0.73
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	30.6	15559	1.7	0.6	8.5	18.0	13.3	-	0.44
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	102.1	3070	2.0	0.8	-0.5	13.9	14.8	15.4	0.45
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	601.8	38766	1.6	0.7	10.8	16.4	15.5	15.3	0.62
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	171.7	5724	1.8	0.9	10.2	20.4	16.2	14.6	0.60
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	84.3	456	2.3	1.1	11.5	15.7	13.7	13.0	0.45
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	227.2	24731	1.6	0.6	2.2	13.9	11.4	15.4	0.40
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	580.6	17653	1.7	0.6	6.4	18.3	14.3	15.5	0.54
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	81.8	4485	1.8	0.4	9.3	16.8	13.4	14.7	0.46
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	89.7	9392	1.8	0.6	10.2	21.5	15.0	15.6	0.48
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	326.7	30712	1.6	0.6	11.5	17.4	16.6	15.9	0.54
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	141.4	42943	1.5	0.6	10.5	15.4	12.1	17.2	0.43
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1365.7	6963	1.9	1.1	8.0	18.8	14.7	13.3	0.54
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	173.2	3464	2.0	1.3	6.0	14.7	11.0	11.7	0.39
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	35.5	3045	1.9	0.6	4.6	16.1	12.4	14.7	0.44
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	79.5	6868	1.8	0.7	7.5	14.9	12.0	14.1	0.42
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	457.0	8143	1.8	0.7	-2.0	10.0	9.9	12.7	0.39
*	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	839.4	5761	1.9	1.1	8.2	14.0	8.6	12.0	0.26
*	Navi Large & Midcap	32.3	307	2.3	0.5	5.1	11.0	10.7	12.9	0.37
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	25.1	4706	1.9	0.8	14.1	18.7	13.7	-	0.38

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1923.3	100455	1.3	0.7	9.5	19.4	18.2	17.1	0.76
*****	JM Flexicap	86.8	5159	1.8	0.7	-0.4	17.2	15.0	16.3	0.51
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	80.6	134253	1.3	0.6	5.5	18.5	16.2	17.5	0.68
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	35.9	3203	1.9	0.4	8.4	16.8	13.3	15.0	0.46
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1497.9	19598	1.7	0.9	3.9	16.1	13.6	13.7	0.49
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	33.1	6004	1.8	0.5	5.1	10.8	9.8	13.6	0.33
*****	Union Flexi Cap	46.8	2349	2.0	0.9	5.2	13.4	11.3	13.1	0.41
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1710.0	25207	1.7	0.9	9.7	16.7	12.3	14.3	0.44
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	195.5	7427	1.9	1.1	7.9	14.7	11.4	11.3	0.41
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	312.3	13390	1.7	0.6	6.1	13.3	10.8	14.3	0.41
***	DSP Flexi Cap	94.2	12165	1.8	0.9	4.0	14.9	11.0	14.4	0.39
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	199.5	5279	1.9	1.2	8.1	16.4	12.7	13.0	0.40
***	Kotak Flexicap	80.1	56853	1.4	0.6	9.9	15.4	11.7	14.2	0.43
***	SBI Flexicap	101.1	23297	1.7	0.8	4.0	11.4	9.5	12.5	0.36
***	Tata Flexi Cap	22.5	3699	1.9	0.6	6.4	14.8	10.5	-	0.40
**	Axis Flexi Cap	24.2	12871	1.7	0.7	5.4	13.4	8.7	-	0.28
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	52.2	12890	1.7	0.8	-3.1	18.4	10.0	12.4	0.32
**	Navi Flexi Cap	21.7	261	2.2	0.6	8.9	11.9	10.5	-	0.37
**	UTI Flexi Cap	276.2	22886	1.7	1.1	-3.7	8.0	5.1	11.4	0.16
**	LIC MF Flexi Cap	90.1	1000	2.3	1.6	8.7	12.7	9.3	10.2	0.31
**	Shriram Flexi Cap	18.4	131	2.4	0.5	2.8	8.9	7.7	-	0.22
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	206.4	346	2.7	2.6	2.4	13.0	10.1	10.1	0.33
-	Quant Flexi Cap	91.4	6354	1.8	0.7	5.7	15.6	18.1	19.0	0.53

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	260.3	3096	2.0	0.9	4.1	16.3	14.1	14.1	0.45
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	742.5	16315	1.7	0.9	6.7	18.1	14.9	14.9	0.56
-	Invesco India Multicap	111.2	4001	1.9	0.7	-2.3	13.7	11.9	13.2	0.38
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	33.2	6174	1.8	0.5	11.0	18.4	16.0	-	0.51
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	276.5	50820	1.5	0.7	8.6	19.6	18.7	15.8	0.67
-	Quant Multi Cap	555.1	7274	1.8	0.7	0.0	10.3	13.4	16.7	0.37
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	347.1	2827	2.0	0.9	5.7	15.3	13.6	14.9	0.47

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	95.6	14355	1.7	0.5	14.2	23.5	18.9	18.6	0.60
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	186.3	94257	1.4	0.7	14.5	23.0	20.0	18.4	0.74
*****	Quant Mid Cap	188.4	7341	1.8	0.8	-2.2	13.8	17.6	15.6	0.51
*****	Invesco India Midcap	162.7	10772	1.7	0.5	14.3	24.0	18.2	17.9	0.56
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	31.7	4440	1.9	0.6	11.1	22.3	18.4	-	0.58
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	82.4	33689	1.6	0.8	-7.0	18.2	19.5	16.1	0.57
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	3990.9	43983	1.5	0.7	16.0	24.1	20.0	18.8	0.67
***	Axis Midcap	105.8	31977	1.6	0.6	10.6	18.1	13.7	16.8	0.46
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	98.1	2341	2.0	0.5	12.2	19.3	15.6	15.7	0.53
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	296.9	7280	1.9	1.0	22.4	23.4	18.0	16.8	0.60
***	Kotak Midcap	126.3	61694	1.4	0.4	14.1	19.1	16.8	18.0	0.57
***	PGIM India Midcap	58.0	10877	1.7	0.5	5.7	11.5	12.9	15.4	0.44
***	SBI Midcap	218.3	23154	1.7	0.9	4.5	15.0	15.0	14.6	0.54
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1312.1	13235	1.7	0.9	13.9	22.7	17.2	15.4	0.57
***	Tata Mid Cap	411.9	5505	1.8	0.6	12.4	19.8	15.7	16.3	0.55
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	722.2	6130	1.9	1.0	8.5	17.9	14.0	13.8	0.50
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2499.0	12328	1.8	1.0	6.1	19.3	14.1	15.0	0.46
**	Taurus Mid Cap	109.1	123	2.5	1.9	7.7	14.2	12.0	15.2	0.36
**	UTI Mid Cap	276.6	11734	1.8	0.9	9.3	15.6	13.2	14.2	0.42
**	DSP Midcap	13.3	19641	1.8	0.8	12.4	18.4	12.1	15.2	0.41
**	HSBC Midcap	372.2	12448	1.7	0.7	19.2	22.3	16.3	16.6	0.47
**	LIC MF Midcap	26.3	337	2.5	1.4	4.1	18.7	12.5	-	0.38

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	152.2	67642	1.4	0.7	7.0	18.7	20.3	20.5	0.59
*****	Quant Small Cap	225.9	27654	1.6	0.8	2.7	17.3	22.3	17.6	0.57
*****	AXIS Small Cap	95.5	26008	1.6	0.6	5.4	15.6	17.0	17.8	0.57

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

★★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	40.9	1904	2.0	0.5	5.0	16.9	17.2	-	0.46
★★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	37.6	9716	1.7	0.4	10.1	21.1	19.0	-	0.55
★★★★★	DSP Small Cap	180.0	16886	1.7	0.8	11.9	17.8	17.4	16.5	0.52
★★★★★	HDFC Small Cap	124.2	37424	1.5	0.7	9.4	16.0	18.3	17.8	0.55
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	78.0	8355	1.8	0.8	6.0	14.1	16.0	15.7	0.58
★★★★★	Kotak Small Cap	226.7	16871	1.7	0.6	2.0	12.4	13.5	16.5	0.43
★★★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	232.2	3306	1.9	0.8	9.4	16.9	16.5	14.3	0.49
★★★★★	Tata Small Cap	31.7	10715	1.7	0.4	-8.1	10.9	15.3	-	0.49
★★★★★	Union Small Cap	45.7	1787	2.1	1.0	13.9	17.3	16.4	15.5	0.46
★★★★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	150.4	12934	1.8	0.9	4.4	16.3	16.9	15.2	0.48
★★★★	HSBC Small Cap	69.5	15375	1.7	0.7	1.7	13.9	17.8	17.7	0.49
★★★★	SBI Small Cap	151.2	34932	1.6	0.8	1.2	11.3	13.2	17.5	0.44
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	78.0	4882	1.9	0.9	10.1	16.0	12.3	12.9	0.36
★★	LIC MF Small Cap	26.8	606	2.4	1.0	2.1	14.8	16.4	-	0.45
★	Edelara Robeco Small Cap	34.5	12769	1.7	0.5	5.8	13.8	17.1	-	0.54
-	Denaweiss Small Cap	39.3	5481	1.8	0.5	7.7	17.1	16.9	-	0.54

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month	3 Month	6 Month	1 Year	
						*Ann	*Ann	*Ann	CAGR	
CASH FUNDS										
LIQUID FUNDS										
-	360 ONE Liquid	2089.9	1283	0.3	0.2	5.3	5.7	5.7	6.0	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Liquid	437.9	51838	0.4	0.2	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	Axis Liquid	3026.3	43636	0.2	0.1	5.3	5.8	5.9	6.3	-
-	Bandhan Liquid	3280.5	17384	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.7	5.7	6.2	-
-	Bank of India Liquid	3131.0	1915	0.1	0.1	5.4	5.9	5.9	6.3	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3123.3	12362	0.3	0.1	5.2	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
-	Canara Robeco Liquid	3270.8	7457	0.2	0.1	5.5	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	DSP Liquidity	3880.3	21058	0.2	0.1	5.4	5.9	5.9	6.3	-
-	Edelweiss Liquid	3475.6	10631	0.2	0.1	5.3	5.8	5.9	6.3	-
-	Groww Liquid	2628.2	164	0.2	0.1	5.5	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	HDFC Liquid	5331.1	67850	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	HSBC Liquid	2708.6	17735	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
-	ICICI Pru Liquid	402.2	53738	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
-	Invesco India Liquid	3734.6	15423	0.2	0.2	5.2	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	ITI Liquid	1414.3	56	0.3	0.1	5.1	5.5	5.6	6.1	-
-	JM Liquid	74.1	2577	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.7	5.7	6.2	-
-	Kotak Liquid	5490.3	42746	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.7	5.7	6.2	-
-	LIC MF Liquid	4910.7	14187	0.2	0.1	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
-	Mahi Manu Liquid	1768.6	1145	0.3	0.2	5.5	5.8	5.9	6.3	-
-	Mirae Asset Liquid	2849.0	12395	0.2	0.1	5.4	5.7	5.8	6.2	-
-	Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.3	1114	0.4	0.2	5.1	5.4	5.5	5.8	-
-	Navil Liquid	29.5	84	0.2	0.2	5.1	5.4	5.4	5.8	-
-	Nippon Ind Liquid	6630.2	32736	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.7	5.8	6.2	-
-	Parag Parikh Liquid	1506.6	5098	0.2	0.1	5.3	5.8	5.7	6.1	-
-	PGIM India Liquid	353.7	677	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	Quant Liquid	42.9	1261	0.5	0.2	5.2	5.6	5.6	6.0	-
-	Quantum Liquid	36.3	567	0.3	0.2	5.1	5.5	5.5	5.8	-
-	SBI Liquid	4245.3	66119	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.7	5.7	6.2	-
-	Sundaram Liquid	2394.6	6221	0.4	0.1	5.2	5.6	5.7	6.1	-
-	Tata Liquid	4280.0	33551	0.3	0.2	5.4	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	Union Liquid	2615.1	7923	0.2	0.1	5.3	5.8	5.9	6.3	-
-	UTI Liquid	4458.3	27263	0.2	0.1	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.3	-
-	WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1460.5	600	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.7	5.7	6.1	-
ARBITRAGE FUNDS										

ARBITRAGE FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.7	26792	1.0	0.3	5.5	6.2	6.0	6.3	-
-	Axis Arbitrage	19.5	9212	1.0	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.1	6.2	-
-	Bandhan Arbitrage	33.7	8650	1.1	0.4	5.6	6.2	5.9	6.0	-
-	Bank of India Arbitrage	14.3	49	0.9	0.4	6.0	6.2	5.8	5.8	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.7	1362	1.1	0.3	5.8	6.1	5.8	6.0	0.00
-	DSP Arbitrage	15.5	6923	1.0	0.4	5.8	6.3	6.0	6.0	-
-	Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.2	15452	1.1	0.4	6.1	6.4	6.1	6.1	-
-	HDFC Arbitrage	31.9	24768	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.4	6.1	6.2	-
-	HSBC Arbitrage	19.8	2433	0.9	0.3	6.7	6.5	6.1	6.1	-
-	ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	35.7	32989	0.9	0.4	6.2	6.5	6.1	6.3	-
-	Invesco India Arbitrage	33.3	28527	1.1	0.4	6.1	6.6	6.2	6.3	-
-	ITI Arbitrage	13.5	49	0.9	0.2	7.0	7.4	6.5	6.4	-
-	JM Arbitrage	33.9	355	1.1	0.4	6.2	6.4	6.0	5.7	-
-	Kotak Arbitrage	39.0	71265	1.0	0.4	6.2	6.5	6.1	6.2	-
-	LIC MF Arbitrage	14.4	277	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.2	5.9	5.9	-
-	Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.8	98	1.1	0.4	5.3	5.9	5.7	5.4	-
-	Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.6	3834	0.9	0.2	6.0	6.5	6.2	5.9	-
-	Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.6	16515	1.0	0.3	6.8	6.3	6.1	6.0	1.70
-	PGIM India Arbitrage	19.1	105	1.0	0.4	6.0	6.1	5.7	5.8	-
-	SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.2	44393	0.9	0.4	6.2	6.5	6.1	6.3	-
-	Sundaram Arbitrage	15.0	335	1.0	0.3	6.6	6.5	6.0	6.0	-
-	Tata Arbitrage	15.0	21327	1.1	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.0	6.3	-
-	Union Arbitrage	14.6	276	1.0	0.4	5.9	6.2	5.8	5.8	-
-	UTI Arbitrage	36.5	11070	0.8	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.2	6.4	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year	2 Year	3 Year	5 Year	
						CAGR	CAGR	CAGR	CAGR	
DEBT FUNDS										
DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Savings	571.9	21467	0.6	0.3	7.1	7.3	7.4	6.3	9.89
★★★★★	Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Dur	1604.4	670	0.5	0.3	6.6	6.9	7.1	6.1	2.25
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4190.5	10672	1.1	0.4	6.5	6.8	6.8	6.7	28.54
★★★★	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	15.8	3732	0.5	0.3	6.5	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
★★★★	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	28.9	16816	0.8	0.4	6.8	7.0	7.1	6.0	10.98
★★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1362.0	1809	0.5	0.1	6.7	7.1	7.2	6.1	1.66
★★★★	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4402.2	3946	1.0	0.3	6.3	6.7	6.8	6.2	10.88
★★★★	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.3	5824	1.2	0.4	6.3	6.5	6.6	5.6	8.95
★★★★	DSP Ultra Short	3533.1	3714	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.5	6.7	5.5	10.16
★★★★	HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.8	17171	0.7	0.4	6.6	6.9	7.0	5.9	4.22
★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1409.1	2874	0.3	0.2	6.7	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
★★★★	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2802.3	1292	0.8	0.2	6.4	6.7	6.9	5.7	11.55
★★★★	Kotak Savings	44.6	16105	0.8	0.4	6.6	6.8	6.9	5.8	8.20
★★★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1430.1	217	0.7	0.3	6.4	6.8	6.9	5.8	4.38
★★★★	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6219.9	13685	0.6	0.4	6.6	6.9	7.0	5.9	8.23
★★★★	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1410.8	541	1.0	0.5	5.9	6.3	6.4	5.4	-
★★★	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3278.8	165	0.9	0.3	6.1	6.3	6.3	5.4	6.68
★★★	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1370.5	230	1.2	0.2	6.0	6.4	6.3	5.4	2.32
★★★	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.3	165	0.9	0.5	5.9	6.3	6.5	5.5	-
★★★	Tata Ultra Short Term	14.7	3793	1.2	0.3	6.2	6.5	6.6	5.5	12.54
★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3940.2	563	1.0	0.4	6.1	6.4	6.5	5.3	-
★	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.0	441	1.0	0.2	5.2	5.5	5.7	4.7	-
★	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2774.8	1907	1.4	0.2	5.5	5.9	6.0	5.0	1.63

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Savings	567.8	31284	0.6	0.4	7.3	7.5	7.6	6.5	7.25
★★★★★	UTI Low Duration	3698.5	2990	0.4	0.3	7.1	7.3	7.3	6.3	5.72
★★★★	Axis Treasury Advantage	3223.1	7831	0.7	0.3	7.0	7.2	7.3	6.1	7.92
★★★★	DSP Low Duration	20.6	5593	0.6	0.3	6.6	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
★★★★	HDFC Low Duration	60.1	25582	1.1	0.5	6.8	7.0	7.1	6.0	11.02
★★★★	HSBC Low Duration	29.8	1009	0.9	0.4	8.1	7.7	7.6	6.2	12.61
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	681.5	15209	1.2	0.4	6.5	6.7	6.8	5.8	10.10
★★★★	Bandhan Low Duration	40.1	5926	0.7	0.3	6.6	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
★★★★	Canara Robeco Savings	43.8	1350	0.5	0.2	6.8	7.0	7.1	5.8	-
★★★★	Invesco India Low Duration	3933.3	2065	0.7	0.3	6.7	7.0	7.1	5.9	8.36
★★★★	JM Low Duration	38.5	222	0.9	0.4	6.6	6.9	6.9	5.7	5.62
★★★★	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3894.2	10969	1.0	0.4	6.8	7.0	7.0	6.0	8.89
★★★★	SBI Low Duration	3625.4	16391	0.9	0.4	6.5	6.8	6.9	5.7	1.71
★★★★	Tata Treasury Advantage	4089.9	3491	0.6	0.2	6.8	7.0	7.1	6.0	3.00
★★★	Kotak Low Duration	3475.0	16393	1.2	0.4	6.7	6.9	6.9	5.8	10.70
★★★	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1696.5	573	1.1	0.3	6.4	6.7	6.8	5.6	15.12
★★★	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2345.5	2720	0.9	0.2	6.5	6.9	6.9	5.7	3.32
★★★	Sundaram Low Duration	3584.1	470	1.2	0.4	6.2	6.7	6.7	5.6	2.77
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	41.6	301	1.0	0.3	6.4	6.6	6.7	5.6	5.02
★★★	LIC MF Low Duration	41.0	2018	1.2	0.3	6.3	6.6	6.7	5.6	2.58

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS										
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Money Market	4325.9	21876	0.4	0.2	7.0	7.2	7.4	6.3	-
★★★★★	UTI Money Market	3215.6	20320	0.2	0.1	7.0	7.3	7.4	6.3	-
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Money Manager	385.6	30778	0.4	0.2	6.9	7.2	7.4	6.3	-
★★★★	Axis Money Market	1492.2	23790	0.3	0.2	7.0	7.3	7.4	6.3	-
★★★★	ICICI Pru Money Market	395.7	35305	0.4	0.2	7.0	7.3	7.4	6.2	-
★★★★	Kotak Money Market	4681.6	33661	0.4	0.2	6.9	7.2	7.3	6.2	-
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Money Market	1436.0	4965	0.4	0.2	6.8	7.0	7.1	5.8	-
★★★★	Franklin Ind Money Market	52.3	4352	0.3	0.1	7.0	7.2	7.3	6.1	-
★★★★	HDFC Money Market	5957.7	33094	0.4	0.2	6.9	7.2	7.3	6.2	-
★★★★	PGIM India Money Market	1380.2	226	0.5	0.2	6.7	6.9	7.0	5.8	-
★★★★	Sundaram Money Market	15.6	2334	0.3	0.2	6.9	7.1	7.2	6.0	-
★★★★	Tata Money Market	4922.2	36819	0.4	0.2	7.0	7.2	7.4	6.3	-
★★★	DSP Savings	54.8	8549	0.4	0.2	6.6	6.9	7.1	5.9	-
★★★	HSBC Money Market	27.5	5379	0.3	0.2	6.8	7.1	7.1	5.8	-
★★★	Invesco India Money Market	3171.2	6596	0.4	0.2	6.7	7.0	7.1	5.9	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
★ ★	SBI Savings	43.1	35418	0.7	0.3	6.6	6.9	6.9	5.8	-
★	Bandhan Money Market	42.0	14805	0.4	0.1	6.9	7.0	7.0	5.7	-
★	Edelweiss Money Market	29.5	3027	0.7	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.6	5.4	-
DEBT - SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Short Term	62.6	22852	1.1	0.5	7.3	7.4	7.6	6.5	10.20
★★★★★	UTI Short Duration	32.8	3090	0.8	0.4	6.8	7.0	7.3	7.1	9.73
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Short Term	49.4	9386	1.0	0.4	7.0	7.3	7.4	6.3	9.99
★★★★	Axis Short Duration	32.1	11860	0.9	0.4	7.4	7.5	7.5	6.2	9.66
★★★★	HDFC Short Term Debt	33.3	17271	0.7	0.4	7.2	7.5	7.6	6.4	8.21
★★★★	Nippon Ind Short Duration	54.8	8367	0.9	0.4	7.3	7.5	7.5	6.2	7.92
★★★	Bandhan Short Duration	59.1	10283	0.8	0.3	6.7	7.2	7.3	5.9	-
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Short Duration	30.2	297	1.1	0.4	6.7	7.0	7.2	5.9	1.70
★★★	HSBC Short Duration	27.4	4308	0.7	0.3	7.0	7.2	7.1	5.8	-
★★★	Kotak Bond Short Term	53.9	17568	1.1	0.4	6.6	7.0	7.1	5.8	-
★★★	Mirae Asset Short Duration	16.3	580	1.1	0.2	6.5	6.9	6.9	5.7	0.86
★★★	SBI Short Term Debt	33.3	17213	0.9	0.4	7.0	7.3	7.3	6.0	6.00
★★★	Sundaram Short Duration	45.9	201	0.7	0.3	6.7	7.2	7.2	6.1	2.50
★★	Canara Robeco Short Duration	26.2	366	1.0	0.4	6.2	6.6	6.6	5.4	-
★★	DSP Short Term	48.1	3743	0.9	0.4	6.6	6.9	7.1	5.7	-
★★	Invesco India Short Duration	3687.2	1064	1.1	0.4	6.7	6.9	7.1	5.6	5.46
★ ★	Tata Short Term Bond	49.3	3745	1.2	0.3	5.9	6.5	6.7	5.5	-
★	Groww Short Duration	2148.2	94	1.0	0.3	6.5	6.6	6.3	5.0	-
★	LIC MF Short Duration	15.1	194	1.2	0.4	6.4	6.8	6.8	5.2	5.52
-	Bank of India Short Term Income	27.7	279	1.0	0.5	6.3	7.6	7.2	10.2	2.89
-	MahI Manu Short Duration	13.2	89	1.3	0.4	6.5	6.9	7.0	5.7	15.65
DEBT - MEDIUM DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Medium Duration	16.4	139	1.1	0.5	9.3	8.7	8.5	9.1	34.62
★★★★	Axis Strategic Bond	29.2	2122	1.3	0.7	7.8	7.9	8.0	6.8	48.53
★★★★	ICICI Pru Medium Term Bond	46.9	5683	1.4	0.7	8.0	7.9	7.8	6.8	35.20
★★★★	HDFC Medium Term Debt	58.5	3873	1.3	0.7	7.1	7.3	7.4	6.3	31.08
★★★★	Kotak Medium Term	23.8	2007	1.6	0.7	8.0	8.0	8.1	6.7	41.90
★★★	SBI Medium Duration	53.0	6819	1.2	0.7	6.8	7.3	7.5	6.3	42.94
★★	DSP Bond	84.4	311	0.8	0.4	6.7	7.1	7.4	6.1	-
★★	HSBC Medium Duration	21.2	746	1.1	0.4	6.9	7.4	7.5	6.2	31.20
★	Bandhan Medium Duration	47.0	1364	1.4	0.7	5.8	6.5	6.7	5.3	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Medium Term	72.3	3070	1.6	0.8	10.0	11.2	9.9	12.0	39.10
-	Sundaram Medium Duration	40.6	35	2.1	1.1	5.1	5.5	5.7	4.3	2.86
-	UTI Medium Duration	18.8	39	1.5	0.8	6.0	6.6	6.8	6.2	25.74

FPIs sell ₹39,451 crore in Indian markets last week

RELENTLESS SELLING. Equities bore the brunt as ₹23,457.02 crore was sold in five sessions

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) remained net sellers in Indian markets for the fifth consecutive session on Friday, pulling out a net ₹7,491.51 crore that day, according to daily trends data released by NSDL. Over five trading sessions up to Friday, FPIs had pulled out a whopping ₹39,450.60 crore from Indian markets.

Equity bore the brunt of the selling, with net outflows of ₹7,375.05 crore on March 13. The stock exchange segment alone saw net equity sales of ₹7,311.10 crore, while the primary market and other segments recorded a net outflow of ₹63.95 crore. Gross equity purchases stood at ₹16,081.97 crore against gross sales of ₹23,457.02 crore.

MIXED IN DEBT
Debt instruments offered a



WEEKLY PEAK. Daily net outflows ranged from ₹7,491.51 crore on March 13 to ₹8,405.83 crore on March 12, the heaviest single-day outflow of the week

mixed picture. The ‘Debt - General Limit’ turned positive, recording a net inflow of ₹503.92 crore, driven largely by primary market activity of ₹765.42 crore in purchases. ‘Debt - VRR’ also posted a marginal net inflow of ₹87.89 crore. However, ‘Debt - FAR’ remained under pressure with net outflows of ₹511.52 crore.

Mutual fund schemes together saw a net outflow of ₹197.72 crore, with debt schemes accounting for ₹153.36

crore of that total.

The week’s selling was relentless. Daily net outflows ranged from ₹7,491.51 crore on March 13 to ₹8,405.83 crore on March 12, the heaviest single-day outflow of the week. March 11 saw outflows of ₹7,983.88 crore, followed by ₹7,960.37 crore on March 10 and ₹7,609.01 crore on March 9.

VK Vijayakumar, Chief Investment Strategist at Geojit Investments Ltd, noted that “The FPI selling continued unabated in

March. FPIs were net sellers on all trading days in March. The total FPI selling through exchanges till March 13 stood at ₹54,455 crore.”

Shrikant Chouhan, Head of Equity Research at Kotak Securities, said FPIs were “net cash sellers to the tune of ₹46,166.58 crore as of March 2026 (till date).” He described global equity markets as “remaining... under stress amid continued conflict in West Asia and the absence of off-ramps,” and said... that FPI “flows are expected to remain volatile.”

On the derivatives front, FPI open interest in index futures rose to 2,87,383 contracts (44,829.76 crore) on March 13, up from 2,69,670 contracts on March 12. Stock futures open interest stood at 68,45,218 contracts worth ₹4,23,622.66 crore. Index options open interest was at 29,03,070 contracts valued at ₹4,50,916.22 crore.

Human judgment, adaptability will remain critical despite AI advances: Mridula Ramesh

Our Bureau
Chennai

Amid growing fears that Artificial Intelligence (AI) can replace millions of jobs, the real challenge for professionals is not technology itself but how people choose to respond to it, said Mridula Ramesh, Founder, Sundaram Climate Institute and Executive Director, Sundaram Textiles Ltd.

Anxiety around AI today mirrors earlier fears about automation in industries such as textiles, she said while addressing the MMA Women Managers’ Convention 2026 on the topic of ‘Women Leading with Purpose, Power & Generosity’, on Saturday. *businessline* is the media partner for the event.

PEOPLE ADAPT
Ten years ago, many in the textile industry wor-



(From left) D Lakshminarayanan, President, Madras Management Association; Mridula Ramesh, Author and Founder, Sundaram Climate Institute and ED, Sundaram Textiles Ltd; and Sandhya Shekhar, Convention Chairperson

ried that robots would take away jobs and shift manufacturing back to countries such as the US. However, the industry did not vanish. It evolved. Companies gradually integrated automation into production while workers adapted by developing new skills. The same is likely with AI, she said.

Mridula Ramesh argued that several core

capabilities that define effective managers cannot be replicated by machines. These include the ability to handle difficult people, motivate teams, build trust and navigate uncertainty.

For instance, in a company, there will always be challenging personalities and unexpected situations. The ability to manage people and build trust is something AI

cannot take away, she said.

In uncertain environments — particularly after the disruptions seen globally over the last few years — human judgment and adaptability remain critical, she said.

AI NOT INFALLIBLE

“AI systems are not infallible. Sometimes you ask a chatbot a question and it gives you a completely wrong answer. At that moment, you realise why human judgment still matters,” she added.

For professionals worried about technological disruption, she said the key lies in shifting mindset — from seeing oneself as a victim of change to recognising one’s ability to adapt.

“Instead of asking why is this happening to me? the more powerful question is ‘Given that this is happening, what can I do?’, she said.

Zydus’ anaemia drug gets China approval

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Zydus Lifesciences on Saturday said its drug Desidustat to treat anaemia in Chronic Kidney Disease (CKD) patients has received marketing approval in China, opening up a large market for the Ahmedabad-based drugmaker.

The approval was granted by China’s drug regulator, the National Medical Products Administration. CMS International Development and Management Ltd, a wholly owned subsidiary of China Medical System Holdings, had obtained an exclusive licence for the drug from Zydus in 2020.

In August 2025, *businessline* had reported that Zydus had completed clinical trials for Desidustat in China and was preparing for a commercial launch. Desidustat is an oral drug that helps the body produce more red blood cells and improve iron availability in patients whose kidneys are unable to produce enough erythropoietin — a hormone required for red blood cell production.

China is estimated to have more than 120 million CKD patients, with a large number anaemic.

Sharvil Patel, Managing Director, Zydus Lifesciences, said: “...Our life-changing discoveries are driven by a commitment to improving patient outcomes globally.”

JSW Steel starts work on Mozambique coking coal mine

Our Bureau
Mumbai

JSW Steel has started work on its coking coal mining project Minas de Revuboe (Mdr) in the Moatize coal basin in Mozambique. Mdr has 850 million tonnes (mt) of reserves and the potential to yield 250 mt of usable coking coal.

In the first phase, JSW Steel targets producing 2.4 mtpa of hard coking coal over two-and-half years. Mdr is located about 10 km north of Tete city, 450 km north of Beira Port and 900 km south-west of Nacala Port, positioning it as one of the most favourably located coking coal assets globally for supply to Indian steel plants. The project will be key for JSW Steel’s backward integration strategy and is expected to provide long-term supply assurance for one of the most critical and cost-intensive inputs in steel manufacturing.

India’s domestic premium coking coal resources remain limited, making captive overseas sourcing a strategic imperative, said the company.

Parth Jindal, scion of JSW Group, said the project marks a pivotal milestone in securing premium hard coking coal reserves in Africa for cost optimisation.

Daniel Francisco Chapo, President, Republic of Mozambique, said with the development of the Mdr project, Mozambique looks forward to creating a world-class mining asset.

TN offers ₹2/unit power subsidy to eateries switching to electric stoves

Press Trust of India
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government on Saturday announced a subsidy of ₹2 per unit of electricity for restaurants, hotels and tea shops that switch to electric stoves from commercial LPG cylinders.

Chief Minister MK Stalin has been holding review meetings since the West Asia conflict led to a shortage of LPG cylinders for eateries, the government said.

“This subsidy will remain in effect as long as



the commercial LPG usage restrictions announced by the Centre are in place,” Additional Chief Secretary J Radhakrishnan said. Briefing reporters at

the Secretariat here, he said electricity consumption by hoteliers and restaurants has increased, with demand rising by about 50 MW above the average in the recent days.

ALTERNATIVE FUELS

Referring to 60,698 factories operating in the State after obtaining the consent from the State Pollution Control board, Radhakrishnan, who is also the Chairman and Managing Director of Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd, said that henceforth

these factories do not require additional certificates from the Pollution Control Board to run their business for using alternative fuels such as kerosene.

Pointing out that the Centre has prioritised the supply of commercial LPG cylinders to hospitals and educational institutions, he said a State-level committee has been formed under the leadership of the Chief Secretary to monitor the systematic allocation of the LPG cylinders to commercial establishments.

Hindalco halts extruded aluminium products sale

Bloomberg

Hindalco Industries Ltd has notified customers that it is suspending sales of extruded aluminium products in the wake of the impact of the Iran war on the metal’s complex global supply chain.

The conflict has already prompted some aluminium smelters in West Asia to suspend sales due to the effective halt on shipping through

the Strait of Hormuz, but manufacturers and industrial businesses in India are also facing disruptions to gas supplies transiting through crucial waterway.

As the supply-chain turmoil grows, Hindalco has invoked *force majeure* clauses in supply contracts with buyers of its extruded aluminium products, according to people familiar with the matter, who asked not to be identified because the communications were private.

Maithan Alloys buys 12.98 lakh equity shares in Bank of India

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Maithan Alloys Ltd said it acquired 12,98,500 equity shares of Bank of India (BoI) on Friday for ₹19.82 crore through the stock exchange.

This acquisition is to reap the long-/short-term investment benefits, Maithan Alloys said in a regulatory filing.

TAKE BACKSEAT

The company, which manufactures and exports value-added manganese alloys and now holds 0.03 per cent in BoI, said it does not intend to acquire control whether directly or indirectly of the management of the target entity.

Maithan Alloys equity shares on Friday closed at ₹926.30 apiece, down 1.48 per cent over the previous close on BSE. BoI equity shares closed at ₹150.05 apiece, down 3.04 per cent over the previous close on BSE.

Waaree Energies breaks ground for 10 GW solar ingot, wafer unit in Nagpur

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Waaree Energies Ltd on Friday announced the groundbreaking of what it described as “India’s largest integrated solar ingot and wafer manufacturing facility,” at Butibori in Nagpur.

The upcoming facility will house 10 GW capacity each for solar ingots and wafers, forming a key part of India’s solar photovoltaic value chain. Once operational, it is expected to significantly boost domestic manufacturing of these critical upstream components and help reduce India’s reliance on imported materials. The project will be developed on 300 acres at an investment of ₹6,200 crore.

The announcement was made at an event attended by senior Maharashtra government leaders and industry stakeholders, including Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis, and Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari.

According to the company, the facility will focus on producing high-purity solar ingots



and wafers, which serve as the foundational materials used in solar photovoltaic manufacturing.

CLEAN ENERGY PIVOT

Once operational, the facility is expected to create over 8,000 direct and indirect jobs.

“India’s clean energy transition will be powered not only by renewable deployment but also by building strong domestic manufacturing capabilities across the solar value chain,” said Hitesh Doshi, Chairman and Managing Director of Waaree Energies.

The firm operates manufacturing facilities with total solar PV module capacity of about 22.3 GW globally and solar cell manufacturing capacity of up to 5.4 GW.

NMDC iron ore output hits record 50 mt in 2025-26

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

NMDC Ltd, a Central public sector enterprise, clocked a record output of 50 million tonnes of iron ore in a single financial year in 2025-26. It expects to add an additional 2-3 million tonnes, factoring in the production in the remainder of the year.

The 48-year-old organisation, which registered a modest production of 10 mt in 1978, recorded an output of 44 mt in 2024-25.

“The production has increased by nearly two-thirds since 2015, rising from about 30 mt to 50 mt, with nearly one-fifth of the current capacity added in the last four years, the fastest expansion in the company’s history.

PRIORITIES SET

“As India advances towards its target of expanding steel-making capacity to 300 million tonnes by 2030, ensuring a stable and reliable domestic supply of iron ore has become a strategic priority,” Amitava Mukherjee, Chairman and Managing Director, NMDC, said.

Modi accuses TMC of opposing SIR to protect ‘infiltrators vote bank’

Our Bureau
Kolkata

Amid the ongoing uproar over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in West Bengal, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday accused the ruling Trinamool Congress of opposing the SIR exercise to protect its “vote bank of infiltrators”.

Addressing a rally at Kolkata’s historic Brigade Parade Ground, Modi alleged that “unchecked illegal immigration” under the Trinamool Congress government in the State had altered the demographic balance in several parts.

The Trinamool Congress has alleged that the SIR exercise conducted by the Election Commission had been marked by procedural violations, technical failures, and arbitrary decisions that threatened the integrity of the electoral process. Moreover, Chief Minister and Trinamool Congress supreme Mamata Banerjee alleged “arbitrary deletion of voters” from the post-SIR electoral rolls, accusing the BJP and the Election Commission of conspiring to “disenfranchise” Bengali voters ahead of the Assembly elec-

tions. “These people oppose SIR so that the names of infiltrators cannot be removed from the voter list, and the voter list cannot be purified. They are not even ready to remove the names of those who are dead,” Modi said, adding the Trinamool Congress feared the SIR exercise because it would remove the names of illegal voters.

The Prime Minister slammed the Trinamool Congress government for its alleged corruption, money syndicates and years of “misrule”.

TENSIONS FLARE

Addressing the massive rally from a stage, modelled on the famous Dakshineswar Kali Temple, Modi claimed that “the end of the reign of jungle rule in Bengal will come” and stated that there is a voice in every corner of Bengal that the BJP will form the government in the State.

Tensions flared up in the city after clashes broke out between supporters of the Trinamool Congress and the BJP at central Kolkata, about 5 km from the Brigade Parade Ground. Supporters of both the parties pelted stones at each other and raised slogans.

Ramky Infra arm to build ₹3,000 cr Pharma Park in Maharashtra

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Ramky Infrastructure Ltd has bagged a ₹3,000-crore project to develop a ‘high-tech Pharmaceutical Park’ at the Dighi Port Industrial Area in Raigad district of Maharashtra. The large-scale integrated project will comprise industrial zones, commercial areas, common infrastructure, and utilities.

A concession agreement between the Maharashtra Industrial Development Corporation and Maha Integrated Life Sciences City Ltd, a wholly owned subsidiary of Ramky Infrastructure Ltd, has been signed to develop the project on 1,000 hectare.

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